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Systems and methods for data encryption, decryption, and authentication

Abstract

A computer-implemented method for encrypting data may include (1) generating a pair of integer values; (2) evaluating at least one property of the pair of values; (3) applying selection logic to the pair of values to accept or reject the pair based on predefined criteria; and (4) determining the pair of values is accepted based on the applied selection logic and assigning the pair of values as matrix dimensions for encrypting data. A computer-implemented method for encrypting data may include a third-party computing device (1) receiving a module configured to generate data for performing an encryption operation; (2) receiving a request for an encryption value set from a user computing device; (3) generating an encryption value set of unique integers based on at least part of the generated data; and (4) transmitting the generated encryption value set to the user computing device for use in performing an encryption operation.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCES TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation-in-part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 19/080,179, entitled “Systems and Methods for Data Encryption, Decryption, and Authentication,” filed Mar. 14, 2025 that is pending and the entirety of which is incorporated by reference, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 19/034,297, entitled “Systems and Methods for Data Encryption, Decryption, and Authentication,” filed Jan. 22, 2025 and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 12,289,394 on Apr. 29, 2025 and the entirety of which is incorporated by reference, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/655,171, entitled “Systems and Methods for Data Encryption, Decryption, and Authentication,” filed May 3, 2024 and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 12,212,653 on Jan. 28, 2025 and the entirety of which is incorporated by reference, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/466,822, entitled “Systems and Methods for Data Encryption, Decryption, and Authentication,” filed Sep. 14, 2023 and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,895,222 on Feb. 6, 2024 and the entirety of which is incorporated by reference, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/200,211, entitled “Systems and Methods for Data Encryption, Decryption, and Authentication,” filed May 22, 2023 and issued as U.S. Pat. No. 12,034,832 on Jul. 9, 2024 and the entirety of which is incorporated by reference.

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STATEMENT REGARDING FEDERALLY SPONSORED RESEARCH OR DEVELOPMENT

(2) Not Applicable

BACKGROUND OF THE DISCLOSURE

(3) The present disclosure generally relates to computing technology, and more particularly to systems and methods for data encryption, decryption, and authentication.

(4) Conventional cryptographic systems with a hierarchical structure include a trust anchor that is an authoritative entity for which trust is assumed and not derived. For example, in an architecture that implements the X.509 standard, the trust anchor is a root certificate from which the whole

chain of trust is derived. The trust anchor must be in the possession of the trusting party beforehand to make any further certificate path validation possible. Conventional operating systems provide a built-in list of self-signed root certificates to function as trust anchors for applications. Web browsers and applications often provide their own list of trust anchors.

(5) There are several disadvantages associated with such hierarchical cryptographic structures. First, the end-user of an operating system using such structures must implicitly trust in the correct operation of such software, and the software manufacturer, in turn, must delegate trust for certain cryptographic operations to the certificate authorities responsible for the root certificates. Such trust is not always reliable. Second, a malicious actor may modify some of the structure data, such as the list of certificates or the list of trust anchors, such that the malicious actor can decrypt encrypted data.

(6) What is needed, then, are new systems and methods for data encryption, decryption, and authentication.

BRIEF SUMMARY

(7) This Brief Summary is provided to introduce a selection of concepts in a simplified form that are further described below in the Detailed Description. This Summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used as an aid in determining the scope of the claimed subject matter.

(8) The systems and methods disclosed herein may not employ certificate authorities, certificate chains of trust, digital signatures, hashes, or asymmetric encryption in the design of trust anchor architecture. Instead, the systems and methods disclosed herein may include a new scheme and program for creating trust anchors based on context awareness, decision procedures or gateway proofs.

(9) One aspect of the disclosure is a computer-implemented method for generating a trusted setup on a computing device. The method may include generating a unique single user profile (USUP) based on data derived from the computing device. The method may include generating a first binary matrix. The method may include executing a matrix mixing operation on the first binary matrix based on the USUP. Executing the matrix mixing operation may generate a second binary matrix. The method may include generating trust anchor data. Generating the trust anchor data may include selecting a first number and inputting the first number into a remainder generator. The remainder generator may be configured to select a second number, calculate a remainder, wherein the remainder is the remainder of the first number divided by the second number, and output a value pair that includes the second number and the remainder. Generating the trust anchor data may include converting the remainder to a first binary value, and storing the first binary value. At the conclusion of this trusted setup method, the computing device may be ready to encrypt data without using hierarchical cryptographic structures.

(10) Another aspect of the disclosure includes a computer-implemented method for generating a ciphertext. The method may include generating a header for the ciphertext. The header may include data configuring one or more permissions for decrypting the ciphertext. The method may include generating instructions for the ciphertext. The instructions may include data used in the encryption of data. The method may include generating a ciphertext body. Generating the ciphertext body may include receiving the data to be encrypted. Generating the ciphertext body may include retrieving at least one encryption value set. The at least one encryption value set may include a mixing scheme, a bit value table, a first matrix size, a second matrix size, an encryption decider, and a decryption decider. Generating the ciphertext body may include generating at least one character matrix based on the data to be encrypted. Generating the ciphertext body may include executing at least one transformation operation on the at least one character matrix to generate the ciphertext body. The at least one transformation operation may be based on the at least one encryption value set. The method may include generating at least one decryption value set based on the at least one encryption value set. The method may include compiling the header, the instructions, and the

ciphertext body into the ciphertext. As can be seen, the encryption of the plaintext message and the preparation of the ciphertext may not use hierarchical cryptographic structures.

(11) Another aspect of the disclosure includes a computer-implemented method for decrypting a ciphertext. The method may include receiving a ciphertext. The ciphertext may include a header, instructions, and a ciphertext body. The method may include retrieving at least one decryption value set from the instructions. The at least one decryption value set may include a mixing scheme, a bit value table, a first matrix size, a second matrix size, and a decryption decider. the method may include generating at least one bit matrix based on the ciphertext body. The method may include executing at least one transformation operation on the at least one bit matrix to generate a plaintext decryption of the ciphertext body. The at least one transformation operation may be based on the at least one decryption value set. As can be seen, the decryption of the ciphertext body may not use hierarchical cryptographic structures.

(12) The systems and methods disclosed herein include elements that improve the functioning of a computer and improve the technical field of cryptography. As discussed in the Background section above, in conventional hierarchical cryptographic structures, trust is assumed and not derived. One disadvantage of this is that the end-user using such structures must implicitly trust in the correct operation of the implementing software, and the software manufacturer, in turn, must delegate trust for certain cryptographic operations to the certificate authorities responsible for the root certificates. Such trust is not always reliable. Malicious actor may modify some of the structure data, such as the list of certificates or the list of trust anchors, such that the malicious actor can decrypt encrypted data. The systems and methods disclosed herein do not assuming such trust. Instead, users create their own trust anchors during the setup process, and the encryption of data uses data from these trust anchors to encrypt data. Furthermore, the encryption value sets, with their mixing schemes, a bit value tables, matrix sizes, encryption and decryption deciders, and the transformation operations that use them to encrypt data, provide for an unconventional way to encrypt data.

(13) Additionally, another disadvantage of the conventional hierarchical cryptographic structures is that these structures often involve the generation of large prime numbers in order to create public and private keys. Determining whether a large number is prime uses a large amount of computing resources. The systems and methods disclosed here do not generate large prime numbers and, thus, do not use the large amounts of computing resources. Thus, the systems and methods disclosed herein provide for encryption and decryption of data that is both more secure than conventional hierarchical cryptographic structures and more efficient.

(14) Numerous other objects, advantages and features of the present disclosure will be readily apparent to those of skill in the art upon a review of the following drawings and description of various embodiments.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1A is a schematic block diagram illustrating one embodiment of a system for data encryption or decryption.

(2) FIG. 1B is a schematic block diagram illustrating one embodiment of a computing device for use in a system for data encryption or decryption.

(3) FIG. 2 is a flowchart illustrating one embodiment of a method for generating or setting up a trusted setup on the computing device.

(4) FIG. 3 is a flowchart illustrating one embodiment of a method for generating identity- and trust-providing data.

(5) FIG. 4 is a schematic block diagram illustrating one embodiment of a ciphertext in a system for

data encryption or decryption.

(6) FIG. 5 is a schematic block diagram illustrating one embodiment of a ciphertext header.

(7) FIG. 6A is a data flow diagram illustrating one embodiment of the construction of an encryption value set for use in a system for data encryption or decryption.

(8) FIG. 6B is a schematic block diagram illustrating one embodiment of a set of encryption value sets.

(9) FIG. 7 is a flowchart diagram illustrating one embodiment of an encryption method for use in a system for data encryption or decryption.

(10) FIG. 8 is a flowchart diagram illustrating one embodiment of a decryption method for use in a system for data encryption or decryption.

(11) FIG. 9 is a flowchart diagram illustrating one embodiment of a method for encrypting data in order to generate the body of the ciphertext.

(12) FIG. 10A is a data flow diagram illustrating one embodiment of the construction of a decryption value set for use in a system for data encryption or decryption.

(13) FIG. 10B is a is a schematic block diagram illustrating one embodiment of a set of decryption value sets and the corresponding encryption value sets they are derived from.

(14) FIG. 11 is a flowchart diagram illustrating one embodiment of a method for decrypting the body of the ciphertext.

(15) FIG. 12 is a data flow diagram illustrating one embodiment showing the operation of one embodiment of a proof-of-work for use in a system for data encryption or decryption.

(16) FIG. 13 is a schematic block diagram illustrating one embodiment of a system using a third-party computing device to store binary fingerprints for use in a system for data encryption or decryption.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(17) While the making and using of various embodiments of the present disclosure are discussed in detail below, it should be appreciated that the present disclosure provides many applicable inventive concepts that are embodied in a wide variety of specific contexts. The specific embodiments discussed herein are merely illustrative of specific ways to make and use the disclosure and do not delimit the scope of the disclosure. Those of ordinary skill in the art will recognize numerous equivalents to the specific apparatus and methods described herein. Such equivalents are considered to be within the scope of this disclosure and are covered by the claims.

(18) In the drawings, not all reference numbers are included in each drawing, for the sake of clarity. In addition, positional terms such as “upper,” “lower,” “side,” “top,” “bottom,” etc. refer to the apparatus when in the orientation shown in the drawing. A person of skill in the art will recognize that the apparatus can assume different orientations when in use.

(19) Reference throughout this specification to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” “another embodiment,” or similar language means that a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with the embodiment is included in at least one embodiment. Thus, appearances of the phrases “in one embodiment,” “in an embodiment,” “in some embodiments,” and similar language throughout this specification may, but do not necessarily, all refer to the same embodiment, but mean “one or more but not necessarily all embodiments” unless expressly specified otherwise.

(20) The terms “including,” “comprising,” “having,” and variations thereof mean “including but not limited to” unless expressly specified otherwise. An enumerated listing of items does not imply that any or all of the items are mutually exclusive and/or mutually inclusive, unless expressly specified otherwise. As used herein, the term “a,” “an,” or “the” means “one or more” unless otherwise specified. The term “or” means “and/or” unless otherwise specified.

(21) Multiple elements of the same or a similar type may be referred to as “Elements **102(1)-(n)**” where n may include a number. Referring to one of the elements as “Element **102**” refers to any single element of the Elements **102(1)-(n)**. Additionally, referring to different elements “First

Elements **102(1)-(n)**” and “Second Elements **104(1)-(n)**” does not necessarily mean that there must be the same number of First Elements as Second Elements and is equivalent to “First Elements **102(1)-(n)**” and “Second Elements **(1)-(m)**” where m is a number that may be the same or may be a different number than n.

(22) Furthermore, through the disclosure, different matrices may be referred to as having the dimensions m or n. The letters m and n may represent numbers that may be different or may be the same. Also, while a first matrix and a second matrix may both have dimensions indicated by m or n, this does not necessarily mean that both matrices are the same size. The m of the first matrix may be a different value than the m of the second matrix, and the same may be true regarding the n.

(23) As used herein, the term “computing device” may include a desktop computer, a laptop computer, a tablet computer, a mobile device such as a mobile phone or a smart phone, a smartwatch, a gaming console, an application server, a database server, or some other type of computing device. A computing device may include a physical computing device or may include a virtual machine (VM) executing on another computing device. A computing device may include a cloud computing system, a distributed computing system, or another type of multi-device system.

(24) As used herein, the term “data network” may include a local area network (LAN), wide area network (WAN), the Internet, or some other network. A data network may include one or more routers, switches, repeaters, hubs, cables, or other data communication components. A data network may include a wired connection or a wireless connection.

(25) As used herein, the term “computing platform” or “platform” may include a computing environment where a portion of software can execute. A computing platform may include hardware on which the software may execute. The computing platform may include an operating system. The computing platform may include one or more software applications, scripts, functions, or other software. The computing platform may include one or more application programming interfaces (APIs) by which different portions of the software of the platform may communicate with each other or invoke functions. The computing platform may include one or more APIs by which it may communicate with external software applications or by which external software applications may interact with the platform. The computing platform may include a software framework. The computing platform may include one or more VMs. The software platform may include one or more data storages. The software platform may include a client application that executes on an external computing device and that interacts with the platform in a client-server architecture.

(26) As used herein, the term “data storage” may include a tangible device that retains and stores data. Such device may include an electronic storage device, a magnetic storage device, an optical storage device, an electromagnetic storage device, a semiconductor storage device, or any suitable combination of the foregoing. A non-exhaustive list of more specific examples of the devices may include a portable computer diskette, a random access memory (RAM), a read-only memory (ROM), an erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM or flash memory), a static random access memory (SRAM), a hard disk drive (HDD), a solid state drive, a portable compact disc read-only memory (CD-ROM), a digital versatile disk (DVD), a memory stick, a floppy disk, a mechanically encoded device such as punch-cards or raised structures in a groove having instructions recorded thereon, and any suitable combination of the foregoing. “Data storage,” in some embodiments, may include a data structure that stores data, and the data structure may be stored on a tangible data storage. Such data storage may include a file system, a database, cloud storage, a data warehouse, a data lake, or other data structures configured to store data.

(27) As used herein, the terms “determine” or “determining” may include a variety of actions. For example, “determining” may include calculating, computing, processing, deriving, looking up (e.g., looking up in a table, a database or another data structure), ascertaining, or other actions. Also, “determining” may include receiving (e.g., receiving information or data), accessing (e.g., accessing data in a memory, data storage, distributed ledger, or over a network), or other actions. Also, “determining” may include resolving, selecting, choosing, establishing, or other similar

actions.

(28) As used herein, the terms “provide” or “providing” may include a variety of actions. For example, “providing” may include generating data, storing data in a location for later retrieval, transmitting data directly to a recipient, transmitting or storing a reference to data, or other actions. “Providing” may also include encoding, decoding, encrypting, decrypting, validating, verifying, or other actions.

(29) As used herein, the term “access,” “accessing”, and other similar terms may include a variety of actions. For example, accessing data may include obtaining the data, examining the data, or retrieving the data. Providing access or providing data access may include providing confidentiality, integrity, or availability regarding the data.

(30) As used herein, the term “message” may include one or more formats for communicating (e.g., transmitting or receiving) information or data. A message may include a machine-readable collection of information such as an Extensible Markup Language (XML) document, fixed-field message, comma-separated message, or another format. A message may, in some implementations, include a signal utilized to transmit one or more representations of information or data.

(31) As used herein, the term “user interface” (also referred to as an interactive user interface, a graphical user interface or a UI), may refer to a computer-provided interface including data fields or other controls for receiving input signals or providing electronic information or for providing information to a user in response to received input signals. A user interface may be implemented, in whole or in part, using technologies such as hyper-text mark-up language (HTML), a programming language, web services, or rich site summary (RSS). In some implementations, a user interface may be included in a stand-alone client software application configured to communicate in accordance with one or more of the aspects described.

(32) As used herein, the term “modify” or “modifying” may include several actions. For example, modifying data may include adding additional data or changing the already-existing data. As used herein, the term “obtain” or “obtaining” may also include several types of action. For example, obtaining data may include receiving data, generating data, designating data as a logical object, or other actions.

(33) As used herein, the term “data object” may include a logical container for data. A data object may include an instance of an object in a software application implemented with an object-oriented programming language. A data object may include data formatted in an electronic data interchange (EDI) format, such as an extensible Markup Language (XML) object, a JavaScript Object Notation (JSON) object, or some other EDI-formatted object. A data object may include one or more functions that may manipulate the data of the data object. For example, a data object may include the functions or methods of an object in a software application implemented with an object-oriented programming language.

(34) As used herein, the term “decentralized” means that at least a portion of information or functionality is not controlled by a single party. Instead, the decentralized information or functionality is distributed among several parties whose aggregate behavior affects the information or functionality. One example of a decentralized technology is a distributed ledger.

(35) As used herein, the term “distributed ledger” may include a data storage of transactions replicated across and synchronized by multiple computers, called “nodes,” in communication with each other. The nodes may synchronize the data of the distributed ledger, including which transactions are added to the ledger and in what order, using a consensus mechanism. The transactions may be cryptographically secured such that once a transaction is added to the distributed ledger, the transaction cannot be later modified. Basic encryption or cryptography principles—such a public key infrastructure, digital signatures, and other cryptographic technologies—underlie the application of distributed ledger technology. When a user adds a distributed ledger transaction, the user may digitally sign the transaction such that other parties can verify that the transaction did, in fact, originate from that user. One example implementation of a

distributed ledger includes a blockchain.

(36) As used herein, the term “blockchain” may include a list of blocks that are cryptographically linked together. Each block may include one or more blockchain transactions. Each block may include a cryptographic hash of the previous block in the blockchain. Each block may include a timestamp, which may include the timestamp of when the block was generated or when the block was added to the blockchain. The blockchain may be maintained as replicated and synchronized copies across a blockchain network of nodes. The nodes may generate blocks and may determine which transactions are included in which blocks and in what order, and the nodes may synchronize their blockchain copies via a consensus mechanism.

(37) As used herein, a “token” may include a data asset represented by data on a blockchain. A token may be transferable between blockchain users via a transaction from a first user to a second user. As used herein, a “tokenized” asset may refer to an asset whose ownership interest is represented by one or more tokens. Thus, a user who owns a token may own at least a portion of the corresponding asset. A token representing a tokenized asset may directly represent ownership of the asset or indirectly represent ownership of the asset. A token directly representing ownership may include the token itself representing ownership of the asset. A token indirectly representing ownership of the asset may include the token representing ownership of some other thing, which in turn may represent ownership of the asset. As an example of a token indirectly representing ownership of an asset, a token may represent ownership of at least part of a business entity such as a corporation, and the corporation may own a piece of real estate property. The token represents ownership of the piece of real estate property even though it is through ownership of the business entity.

(38) As used herein, the term “transaction” may include a blockchain transaction. A blockchain transaction may include a source address, a destination address, an amount of cryptocurrency or a token, a timestamp indicating when the transaction was generated or other data. As used herein, a “cryptocurrency wallet” may include data that may allow a user of a blockchain network to send or receive cryptocurrency or tokens via the blockchain network. The cryptocurrency wallet may include one or more public keys, private keys, or other cryptographic components used to generate transactions. A cryptocurrency wallet may include a corresponding cryptocurrency wallet address that may uniquely identify the cryptocurrency wallet. As used herein, the terms a first user “sending” a second user cryptocurrency, or a token may include the first user generating a transaction where the destination address is the cryptocurrency wallet address of the second user. Hence, using a cryptocurrency wallet may not mean that cryptocurrency or a token is physically sent from, received at, or held in a cryptocurrency wallet, but, instead, transactions of the blockchain network indicate that the owner of the cryptocurrency wallet has ownership of certain cryptocurrency or tokens.

Overview

(39) FIG. 1A depicts one embodiment of a system **100**. The system **100** may include a system for data encryption or decryption. The system **100** may include a computing device **102**. As can be seen in FIG. 1B, the computing device **102** may include a setup module **104**, a witness module **106**, an encryption module **108**, or a decryption module **110**. The computing device **102** may include a data storage **112**. The system **100** may include other computing devices **120(1)-(n)**. These computing devices **120(1)-(n)** may each include their own setup module **104**, witness module **106**, encryption module **108**, decryption module **110**, or data storage **112**. The computing devices **102**, **120(1)-(n)** may be in data communication with each other over a data network **130**.

(40) In one embodiment, the setup module **104** may set up a logical environment on the computing device **102** for encrypting data and decrypting data. This setup process may include generating data used for encrypting or decrypting data and storing the generated data in the data storage. The encryption module **108** may encrypt data using the stored data. The decryption module **110** may decrypt data received from other computing devices **120(1)-(n)**.

(41) In some embodiments, the system **100** may encrypt data without the use of certificate authorities, certificate chains of trust, digital signatures, hashes, or asymmetric encryption in the design of trust anchor architecture. Instead, the system **100** may utilize novel schemes and modules for creating trust anchors based on context awareness, decision procedures, or gateway proofs.

(42) Generating the Trusted Setup

(43) FIG. 2 depicts one embodiment of a method **200**. The method **200** may include a computer-implemented method for generating or setting up a trusted setup on the computing device **102** of the system **100** of FIG. 1. The method **200** may include generating a unique single user profile (USUP) (step **202**). The method **200** may include generating a first binary matrix (step **204**). The method **200** may include mixing the first binary matrix based on the USUP to generate a second binary matrix (step **206**). The method **200** may include generating trust anchor information (step **208**). The system **100** may then be able to use the trust anchor information to generate one or more trust anchors in order to encrypt or decrypt data. In some embodiments, the setup module **104** may carry out one or more of the steps of the method **200**.

(44) In one embodiment, the method **200** may include generating the unique single user profile (USUP) (step **202**). The setup module **104** may generate the USUP based on one or more pieces of data. The pieces of data may include data from the computing device **102**. The data from the computing device **102** may include a username (e.g., a username of the user on the computing device **102**), a device name (e.g., the device name of the computing device **102** or the system domain host name of the computing device **102**), a user profile directory location (e.g., the user's user directory on the computing device's **102** file system), an executable file directory location (e.g., the directory location of the executable file of the setup module **104**, the encryption module **108**, or the decryption module **110**), a device identifier (e.g., a media access control (MAC) address, a device ID, a product ID, a serial number of a hardware component of the computing device **102**, an Internet Protocol (IP) address), or some other identification number associated with the computing device **102**), or Basic Input/Output System (BIOS) data. The pieces of data may include biometric data (e.g., fingerprint data, face recognition data, iris or retina data, voice data associated with a user of the computing device **102**), geolocation data, behavioral data, or other pieces of data.

(45) In one embodiment the USUP may include one or more pieces of data concatenated together. For example, the USUP may include a text string that includes a concatenation of the username, the user profile directory, the device name, the device MAC address, and the executable file directory location with each piece of data separated by a delimiting character. Thus, the USUP may include the text string jsmith;C:\Users\jsmith\Desktop-JSmith;D8:12:65:C5:75:91;C:\ProgramFiles\EncryptionProgram\encrypt.exe where "jsmith" is the username, "C:\Users\jsmith" is the user profile directory, "Desktop-JSmith" is the device name, "D8:12:65:C5:75:91" is the MAC address, and "C:\ProgramFiles\EncryptionProgram\encrypt.exe" is the executable file directory, and where ";" is the delimiting character.

(46) The method **200** may include generating the first binary matrix (step **204**). The first binary matrix may include an m by n matrix where each cell includes a binary string. In some embodiments, each of m and n may include natural numbers greater than 0. In some embodiments, m and n may be the same value or may be different values. In one embodiment, the first binary matrix may include a 16 by 16 matrix.

(47) In one or more embodiments, each cell of the first binary matrix may include a binary string. The binary strings of different cells may be different lengths, or the binary strings of all the cells may be the same length. For example, each cell of the first binary matrix may include an 8 bit binary string. In one embodiment, the setup module **104** may use a pseudorandom number generator to generate each binary string in the first binary matrix.

(48) In other embodiments, the setup module **104** may select two decimal numbers, add the two numbers together, convert the resulting sum to a binary number, and use this binary number as the

value for the first cell. The setup module **104** may then generate the values of the remaining cells of the first binary matrix by increasing the value from the first cell by a predetermined amount for each remaining cell. The setup module **104** may proceed like this column by column until all cells have a value. As an example, for a first binary matrix of size 16 by 16, the setup module **104** may select the decimal numbers 65 and 66, add them together (131) and use the binary form of this number as the value of the first cell (cell [1][1]). The setup module **104** may increase this value by 1 (132) and use the binary form of 132 as the value for the next cell in the column (cell [2][1]), use the binary form of 133 as the value for the next cell in the column (cell [3][1]), and so on until cell [16][16] has the value of the binary form of 386. While in this example, the predetermined amount by which each cell value is increased is 1, the predetermined amount could be some other number, or could be a sequence of numbers (e.g., the Fibonacci sequence).

(49) In one embodiment, the method **200** may include mixing the first binary matrix based on the USUP to generate the second binary matrix (step **206**). In some embodiments, the step **206** may be called “executing a matrix mixing operation.” Mixing the first binary matrix (step **206**) may include calculating the length of the USUP. The length of the USUP may include the number of text characters in the USUP. The number of text characters may or may not include the delimiting character(s). The length of the USUP may be represented as in binary form. For example, the length of the USUP in the above example is 101, thus, the binary form of 101 is 1100101.

(50) Mixing the first binary matrix (step **206**) may include iterating across the binary form of the length of the USUP and transforming the first binary matrix based on whether the current digit is a 0 or a 1. Transforming the first binary matrix in response to the current digit being 1 may include executing the Transformation Engine P+1 (described below) on the first binary matrix.

Transforming the first binary matrix in response to the current digit being 0 may include executing Transformation Engine P-1 on the first binary matrix. Each time a Transformation Engine (either P+1 or P-1) is executed on the first binary matrix, the first binary matrix may be modified by the Transformation Engine such that the subsequent Transformation Engine executes on the modified first binary matrix. After all of the Transformation Engine executions have occurred, the modified first binary matrix is designated as the second binary matrix.

(51) In one embodiment, the Transformation Engine P+1, the Transformation Engine P-1, a Transformation Engine P-153, a Transformation Engine m(P+1), or a Transformation Engine m(P-1) may include a module, subroutine, function, procedure, object-oriented software method, or other sequence of program instructions. Each Transformation Engine may accept a matrix as input. Each Transformation Engine may execute a different entropy function on the input matrix. The entropy functions may be based on mathematical explanations verses traditional mathematical algorithms. In some embodiments, a Transformation Engine may employ a transformation mixing function based on Claude Shannon's principles of diffusion and confusion. In some embodiments, any subset of two, three, four, or all five of the Transformation Engines may be randomly selected and used to perform an encryption operation. The subset of two or more Transformation Engines may include an unordered or ordered combination of Transformation Engines. The encryption operation may be agnostic to the order in which the transformation engines of the subset are applied.

(52) In one embodiment, the Transformation Engine P+1 may operate according to the following steps: (1) receive a matrix as input; (2) execute permutations on the matrix by shuffling the cells of the matrix; (3) employ cycles on one or more subsets of the matrix, which may include, for each subset, iteratively shuffling the cells of the subset; (4) execute steps 2 through 3 one or more times until the following condition is satisfied: $2x=1=\log_{\text{sub.2}} y=z.\text{sub.1}*(P+1)+w.\text{sub.1}\equiv w.\text{sub.1} \pmod{P+1}$ where: (a) the initial state of the matrix is $x=0$; (b) P =total number of discrete cells in the input matrix; (c) $w.\text{sub.1}=y \pmod{P+1}$; (d) $z.\text{sub.1}=y/P+1$; and (e) x is the number of times steps 2 through 3 are executed such that $x>0\equiv 1 \pmod{P+1}$; and (5) output x .

(53) In one embodiment, the Transformation Engine P-1 may operate according to the following

steps: (1) receive a matrix as input; (2) execute permutations on the matrix by shuffling the cells of the matrix; (3) employ cycles on one or more subsets of the matrix, which may include, for each subset, iteratively shuffling the cells of the subset; (4) execute steps 2 through 3 one or more times until the following condition is satisfied: $2x+1=\log_2 y=z \cdot 2^w$ (P-1)+w.sub.2 $\equiv$ w.sub.2mod(P-1) where: (a) the initial state of the matrix is $x=0$; (b) P=total number of discrete cells in the input matrix; (c) w.sub.2= $y \bmod (P-1)$; (d) z.sub.2= $y/P-1$; and (e) x is the number of times steps 2 through 3 are executed such that $x > 0 \equiv 1 \pmod{P-1}$; and (5) output x.

(54) In one or more embodiments, the Transformation Engine P-153 may increase positional disorder and randomness of the individual cells within a matrix. The Transformation Engine P-153 may perform one or more string dislocation operations on the matrix, which may include shifting the contents of the cells of the matrix. In some embodiments, string dislocation may include moving the contents of the cells by a predetermined number, moving the contents forward or backward in the matrix (e.g., left-to-right, row-by-row; top-to-bottom, column-by-column; etc.). As an example, the Transformation Engine P-153 may move the contents of the cells by two spaces going from left-to-right and row-by-row, and wrapping around to the beginning of the matrix if the end of the matrix is reached.

(55) In one embodiment, the Transformation Engine m(P+1) may operate according to the following steps: (1) receive a matrix as input; (2) execute permutations on the matrix by shuffling the cells of the matrix; (3) employ cycles on one or more subsets of the matrix, which may include, for each subset, iteratively shuffling the cells of the subset; (4) execute steps 2 through 3 one or more times until the following condition is satisfied: $m \cdot \sup x = y = z \cdot (P+1) + w \equiv w \bmod (P+1)$ and $S = k_B \ln \Omega$ when $\Omega = x$ and $w=1$ for number of entropy potentials (i.e., phase space-microstates) associated with the number of discrete material cells for the system, which is a mathematical explanation of the output during each cycle as x increments by 1 where: (a) the initial state of the matrix is $x=0$; (b) m=total number of rows in a matrix; (c) n=total number of columns in a matrix; (d) P=total number of discrete cells in an $m \times n$ matrix; (e) $y = m \cdot \sup x$; (f) $x = \log_2 y$; (g) $w = y \bmod (P+1)$; and (h) $z = \text{Math.Floor}(y/(P+1))$, where z is a member of the set of whole numbers, and there $\exists$ an x such that $x > 0$ will return a final state identical to the initial state after x number of P+1 cycles.

(56) In one embodiment, the Transformation Engine m(P-1) may operate according to the following steps: (1) receive a matrix as input; (2) execute permutations on the matrix by shuffling the cells of the matrix; (3) employ cycles on one or more subsets of the matrix, which may include, for each subset, iteratively shuffling the cells of the subset; (4) execute steps 2 through 3 one or more times until the following condition is satisfied: $m \cdot \sup x = y = z \cdot (P-1) + w \equiv w \bmod (P-1)$ and $S = k_B \ln \Omega$ when $\Omega = x$ and $w=1$ for number of entropy potentials (i.e., phase space-microstates) associated with the number of discrete material cells for the system, which is a mathematical explanation of the output during each cycle as x increments by 1 where: (a) the initial state of the matrix is $x=0$; (b) m=total number of rows in a matrix; (c) n=total number of columns in a matrix; (d) P=total number of discrete cells in an $m \times n$ matrix; (e) $y = m \cdot \sup x$; (f) $x = \log_2 y$; (g) $w = y \bmod (P-1)$; and (h) $z = \text{Math.Floor}(y/(P-1))$, where z is a member of the set of whole numbers, and there $\exists$ an x such that $x > 0$ will return a final state identical to the initial state after x number of P-1 cycles.

(57) In one embodiment, the method **200** may include generating trust anchor information (step **208**). Generating the trust anchor information (step **208**) may include the setup module **104** using a remainder generator. A remainder generator may accept a first number as an input. The remainder generator may select a second number. The remainder generator may select the second number using pseudorandom number generation, accepting the second number as an input, or using some other method. The remainder generator may then calculate a third number where the third number is the remainder of the first number divided by the second number. In other words, the remainder

generator may calculate: (the first number) mod (the second number)=(the third number). The output of the remainder generator may include one or more value pairs of a second number and a third number that satisfy (the first number) mod (the second number)=(the third number). In some embodiments, the remainder generator may be used by other modules of the computing device **102** and at other times.

(58) In one embodiment, generating the trust anchor information (step **208**) may include the setup module **104** selecting a first number. The first number may include a number greater than 0. The first number may include a whole number. The first number may include the length of the USUP, which may have been calculated as part of step **206**. Generating the trust anchor information (step **208**) may include the setup module **104** inputting the first number into a remainder generator in order to obtain three (second number, third number) pairs. Generating the trust anchor information (step **208**) may include storing the remainders (the third numbers) produced as the outputs of the remainder generator. Generating the trust anchor information (step **208**) may include including the second numbers in the setup module **104**, the witness module **106**, the encryption module **108**, or the decryption module **110** for later use.

(59) As an example, the first number may include 101 (the length of the USUP as calculated in step **206**). Generating the trust anchor information (step **208**) may include the setup module **104** inputting the number 101 (the first number) into the remainder generator. The remainder generator may randomly select 6, 27, and 3 as the second numbers. The remainder generator may calculate the remainders (the third numbers) of 101 divided by 6, 27, and 3, respectively, which may include calculating $101 \bmod 6 = 5$, $101 \bmod 27 = 20$, and $101 \bmod 3 = 2$. The remainder generator may output the following value pairs: (6, 5), (27, 20), and (3, 2). The setup module **104** may store the remainders (in this case, 5, 20, and 2) for later use and may include the values 6, 27, and 3 in the setup module **104**, the witness module **106**, the encryption module **108**, or the decryption module **110** for later use.

(60) In one embodiment, after step **206**, the method **200** may include generating one or more file directories. The file directories may be located on the computing device **102** (e.g., in the data storage **112**) or on a data storage in data communication with the computing device **102**. Each file directory may include one or more files. Each file may include trust anchor information and may be considered a trust anchor. In one embodiment, the setup module **104** may select a binary string from the second binary matrix to serve as a file directory name of the one or more file directories. In one embodiment, the setup module **104** may select a binary string from the second binary matrix to serve as a file name of the one or more files. In other embodiments, a file directory name or file name may include a predetermined text string, or a text string specified by the computing device **102** or a user of the computing device **102**.

(61) In one embodiment, the one or more file directories may include seven file directories. The first file directory may include two files. The first file may include decision procedures used to encrypt the USUP to create a real-time binary fingerprint. The second file may include decision procedures to decrypt a user's binary fingerprint (including a user of the computing device **102** or a third-party's binary fingerprint) and compare USUPs in real time.

(62) The second file directory may include two files. The first file may include decision procedures to encrypt a group policy, and the second file may include decision procedures to encrypt document proper header information. The third file directory may include twelve files. Each of the twelve files may include a different matrix encryption value set. The fourth file directory may include one file: a file that includes decision procedures used to encrypt document proper file analysis.

(63) The fifth file directory may include two files. The first file may include decision procedures to decrypt a group policy, and the second file may include decision procedures to decrypt document proper header information. The sixth file directory may include twelve files. Each of the twelve files may include a different matrix decryption value set. The seventh file directory may include a single file: a file that includes decision procedures used to decrypt document proper file analysis.

(64) Creating a Proof of Identity

(65) In one embodiment, the setup module **104** may generate data that provides identity and trust instead of acquiring such data from a third party (e.g., in the form of a digital certificate issued by a third party). FIG. 3 depicts one embodiment of a method **300** for generating such identity- and trust-providing data. The method **300** may include generating a unique single user profile (USUP) (step **302**). The method **300** may include encrypting the USUP (step **304**). The method **300** may include storing the encrypted USUP as a binary fingerprint (step **306**).

(66) In one embodiment, generating the USUP (step **302**) may be similar to step **202** of the method **200** depicted in relation to FIG. 2, discussed above. In some embodiments, the setup module **104** may limit the number of characters in the USUP. For example, the USUP may include a maximum character limit of 140 characters. If the USUP's length is longer than the maximum character limit, the setup module **104** may truncate the USUP to the maximum character limit. In some embodiments, in response to the USUP having a character length of less than the maximum character limit, the computing device may pad the USUP until the USUP has a character length of the maximum character limit.

(67) In one or more embodiments, encrypting the USUP (step **304**) may include encrypting the USUP according to the method **900** of FIG. 9, discussed below. In such an embodiment, the data to be encrypted of step **902** may include the USUP, and the encryption value sets of step **904** may include at least a portion of the trust anchor information generated from the method **200** of FIG. 2, discussed above. The encrypted USUP may represent a binary fingerprint. In some embodiments, the binary fingerprint may have a character length longer than the character length of the USUP. For example, the binary fingerprint may be eight times longer. The binary fingerprint may be x times longer where x is a real number greater than 1. In some embodiments, the binary fingerprint may include binary data. The binary data may include a length of 1,120 binary digits.

(68) In some embodiments, storing the binary fingerprint (step **306**) may include storing the binary fingerprint in a binary file. The binary file may include a file of the one or more files of the one or more file directories discussed above in relation to FIG. 2. The binary file may include a randomly selected file.

(69) In some embodiments, the computing device **102** may transmit the binary fingerprint over a data network to another computing device **120**. The other computing device **120(1)** may use the binary fingerprint, along with other data, to decrypt messages from the computing device or other data.

(70) Ciphertext Architecture

(71) In one embodiment, the computing device's **102** encryption module **108** may encrypt data and send the encrypted data to another computing device **120**. The decryption module **110** of the other computing device **120** may decrypt the received encrypted data. In one embodiment, the encrypted data may take the form a ciphertext. FIG. 4 depicts one embodiment of a ciphertext **400**. The ciphertext **400** may include a blob of binary numbers. The ciphertext **400** may include a header **402**. The ciphertext **400** may include instructions **404**. The ciphertext **400** may include a body **406**. As can be seen in FIG. 4, each of the header **402**, instructions **404**, and body **406** may include binary data.

(72) FIG. 5 depicts one embodiment of the ciphertext's **400** header **402**. In one embodiment, the header **402** may include data that describes, in a machine-readable manner, a decryption policy. The decryption policy may include one or more sets of permissions for the terms of decryption. The header **402** may include three policy classes: a group policy **502**, an entity policy **504**, and a ciphertext policy **506**. Each policy **502**, **504**, **506** may be embedded with certain security or privacy conditions and may contribute to the overall access control conditions for the ciphertext **400** body **406**. In one embodiment, the decryption module **110** of the computing device **120** may process the header **402** and may grant access to the body **406** in response to all conditions described in the policies **502**, **504**, **506** being met. If a condition of a policy **502**, **504**, **506** is not met, the decryption

module **110** may halt and may deny access to the body **406**.

(73) In one embodiment, the group policy **502** may define the context associated with a group and the number of entities in the group authorized to decrypt the ciphertext **400** body **406**. During the trusted setup process described above in relation to the method **200** of FIG. 2, the setup module **104** may establish the group policy **502** by an individual, group, or organization that operates the computing device **102**. The setup module **104** may format the group policy **502** into a single, plaintext string. The software may calculate the length of the group policy **502** string and may present the length as a decimal value. The setup module **104** may use the length as the input to the remainder generator discussed above in relation to step **208** to calculate the three remainders and may convert each remainder to a binary value. Calculating the three remainders may include using the same second numbers as were selected during step **208** during the setup process. The setup module **104** may store the group policy **502** or the binary values in the first file of the second file directory.

(74) In one embodiment, the entity policy **504** may include the binary fingerprint of each entity in the group. The entities in the group may include the sender of the message and the recipient(s) of the message. The computing device may generate the entity policy **504** during the method **200**.

(75) In some embodiments, the ciphertext policy **506** may include one or more unique identifiers. The one or more unique identifiers may include two identifiers. The encryption module **108** may append the one or more unique identifiers to the body **406**. Although the one or more unique identifiers may be appended to the body **406**, they still may be considered included in the ciphertext policy **506**. The one or more identifiers may act as watermarks.

(76) In one embodiment, during the execution of the setup process of the method **200**, the setup module **104** may generate the first unique identifier. The first unique identifier may include a predetermined string of text. The setup module **104** may generate the first unique identifier based on input by the individual, group, or organization. The setup module **104** may calculate the length of the first unique identifier and use the length as the first number in the remainder generator discussed above in relations to step **208** of the method **200**. The remainder calculator may calculate the three remainders, convert them to binary values, and append them to the body **506**. Calculating the three remainders may include using the same second numbers as were selected during step **208** during the setup process. In one embodiment, the first unique identifier may authenticate, to the receiving entity(ies), the identity of the sender of the ciphertext **400**.

(77) In some embodiments, the second unique identifier may include the length of the body **406** as a number of blocks. To calculate the number of blocks, the encryption module **108** may convert the body **406** to binary format, retrieve the values m and n from the files called "Bit Matrix $P+1$ " prepared by the witness module **106**, generate a m by n matrix, and calculate (the length of the body **406** in bits) divided by (the size of the m by n matrix) rounded up the nearest whole number. For example, m may include 32 and n may include 128. Thus, the matrix may include a size of 4,096 (m multiplied by n). The length of the body in bits may include 164,300. Thus, 164,300 divided by 4,096 may equal 40.112 and may be rounded up to 41. Thus, 41 would be the length of the body **406** in as the number of blocks. The setup module **104** may use the number of blocks as the first number in the remainder generator discussed above in relation to step **208** of the method **200**. The remainder generator may calculate the three remainders, convert them to binary values, and append them to the body **406**. Calculating the three remainders may include using the same second numbers as were selected during step **208** during the setup process. In some embodiments, the second unique identifier may demonstrate, to the receiving entity(ies), the integrity of the body **406**. In some embodiments, the setup module **104** may store the first or second unique identifiers or their respective remainders in the data storage **112**.

(78) In one embodiment, the instructions **404** of the ciphertext **400** may include data that the decryption module **110** may use to decrypt the ciphertext body **406**. The details of such data are discussed below in relation to step **910** of the method **900** of FIG. 9. In one embodiment, as part of

the decryption process, the decryption module **110** may recreate the file directory and file configuration that was created during the setup process of the method **200** of FIG. **2**. The successful recreation of the configuration may verify the integrity of each directory and file location. It may also ensure that no deletions, edits, attacks, or movements of a file directory or file has occurred, since the last use of the modules **104-108**. If the recreation of the file directories and files fails, the decryption module **110** may halt.

(79) In one embodiment, the ciphertext **400** body **406** may include the encrypted message that was encrypted by the encryption module **108**. The encryption of the message is discussed in detail below in relation to the method **900** of the FIG. **9**.

(80) Witness Module

(81) In some embodiments, the computing device **102** may include a witness module **106**. The witness module **106** may generate data employed by the encryption module **108** in the encryption method **700** of the FIG. **7**, discussed below. The witness module **106** may create a trusted segregation of duties between the sending user and the recipient user. The witness module **106** may help ensure that each of the sender and the receiver expends a certain level of computational effort to complete a proof of work associated with the encryption/decryption processes. In some embodiments, the sender and the recipient may have no knowledge of the inner workings of the witness module **106**. The witness module **106** may have no access to or knowledge of the plaintext version of the body **406** or ciphertext **400**. The sender may not be able to encrypt plaintext without the encryption value sets from the witness module **106**, and the recipient may not be able to decrypt the ciphertext **400** without the decryption value sets from the sender.

(82) In one embodiment, the encryption module **108** may invoke the witness module **106** as part of the encryption method **700**. In response, the witness module **106** may generate data to be used in the encryption method **700**. The data may include one or more encryption value sets. In one embodiment, an encryption value set may include six values: a mixing scheme, a bit value table, a first matrix size (indicated by the letter m), a second matrix size (indicated by the letter n), an encryption decider, and a decryption decider.

(83) In one embodiment, each value of an encryption value set may belong to one of two classes of values: pre-programmed or decimal. A pre-programmed value may include a binary value that has been pre-programmed into the witness module **106** (e.g., as volatile data included in the witness module **106** or in a configuration file of the witness module **106**). A decimal value may include a value generated by the witness module **106** for the specific instance of running the encryption method **700**. In one embodiment, the mixing scheme and the bit value table may be pre-programmed, and the values m, n, the encryption deciders, and the decryption deciders may be decimal. In some embodiments, the decimal values may be ephemeral and may change each time the encryption module **108** invokes the witness module **106**. In some embodiments, the witness module **106** may generate the pre-programmed values during the setup process of the method **200** of FIG. **2**.

(84) FIG. **6A** depicts one embodiment of a data flow **600**. The data flow **600** may show how each value **602-612** of an encryption value set **620** (in the example of FIG. **6A**, the “Character Matrix P+1” value set **620(1)**) is included in the encryption value set **620**. For example, the two pre-programmed values (i.e., the mixing scheme **602** and the bit value **604**) may be provided by the setup module **104** or may be retrieved from the trusted environment set up by the setup module **104** in the method **200** of FIG. **2**. The first matrix size **606**, the second matrix size **608**, the encryption decider **610**, and the decryption decider **612** may be provided by the witness module **106** as discussed below. In some embodiments, the set of encryption value sets **620** may include fewer than six encryption value sets **620** or more than six encryption value sets **620**. For example, there may be one encryption value set **620**, two encryption value sets **620**, three encryption value sets **620**, four encryption value sets **620**, five encryption value sets **620**, seven encryption value sets **620**, eight encryption value sets **620**, nine encryption value sets **620**, ten encryption value sets **620**,

eleven encryption value sets **620**, or twelve encryption value sets **620**. In some embodiments, the set of encryption value sets **620** may include more than twelve encryption value sets **620**.

(85) In one embodiment, a mixing scheme **602** may include a sequence of executions of the one or more Transformation Engines discussed above (i.e., P+1, P-1, m(P+1), m(P-1), and P-153). The witness module **106** may randomly generate the sequence. The witness module **106** randomly generating the sequence may include the witness module **106** randomly selecting the length of the sequence (i.e., the number of Transformation Engine executions) or the contents of the sequence (i.e., for each slot in the sequence, whether the slot will include an execution of the Transformation Engine P+1, P-1, m(P+1), m(P-1), or P-153). However, in some embodiments, the sequence may include a length of five, and each type of Transformation Engine (P+1, P-1, m(P+1), m(P-1), and P-153) may be used only once. As discussed above, a Transformation Engine may accept a matrix as input, may transform the contents of that matrix, and output a new matrix. In the mixing scheme **602**, the output matrix of a Transformation Engine may be used as the input matrix to the subsequent Transformation Engine until the sequence is complete. For example, the sequence may be in a defined order where the Transformation Engines are executed in the defined order, which may determine the encryption output. The witness module **106** may generate one or more mixing schemes **602** and may randomly select one of the mixing schemes **602** as the output.

(86) As an example, the witness module **106** may randomly generate a mixing scheme **602** that includes the following sequence: P-153, P-1, P+1. Thus, the Transformation Engine P-153 may execute on the input matrix. The output of the Transformation Engine P-153 may be used as the input to the Transformation Engine P-1. The output of the Transformation Engine P-1 may be used as the input to the Transformation Engine P+1. The output of the Transformation Engine P+1 may be the output of the mixing scheme **602**, and the mixing scheme **602** may halt.

(87) In one embodiment, the witness module **106** may select a bit value **604**. The bit value **604** may include a four-bit number. The bit value **604** may identify a bit value table. A bit value table may include a 4 by 4 matrix whose cells include the numbers 0 through 15 distributed throughout the matrix. The setup module **104** may generate one or more bit value tables during the setup process of the method **200** of FIG. 2. The bit value tables may be included in the encryption module **108** or decryption module **110**. Each bit value table may be uniquely identified by a bit value **604**. The witness module **106** selecting a bit value **604** may include the witness module **106** randomly selecting a four-bit number for inclusion in the encryption value set **620** as the bit value **604**.

(88) As an example, a bit value table may include the following matrix:

(89) TABLE-US-00001 0111 0101 0010 1101 1111 1011 0100 0011 0001 1100 0000 1010 1000
0110 1001 1110

The bit value **604** that identifies this bit table may include "0111" (because, for example, the first cell of the bit table is "0111"). Other bit value tables may include the same values (i.e., the numbers 0000 through 1111) but in different locations in the bit table.

(90) In one embodiment, one purpose of a bit table is to further obfuscate binary data. This may include converting a four-bit value into a different value based on the position in the bit table where that four-bit value is found. For example, using the table from the above example, in order to obfuscate the four-bit value 0101 (whose decimal value is 5), one would find the cell bit matrix[5] (i.e., the sixth cell of the table going from left-to-right, row-by-row) and use the value in that cell (in this example, "1011"). In order to un-obfuscate, the reverse process is used. For example, for the obfuscated value "1001," the position of that value is found in the bit table. In the example bit value table above, "1001" is in the cell bit matrix[14]), indicating that the un-obfuscated value is "1110" (whose decimal value is 14).

(91) In some embodiments, the witness module **106** may generate one or more pairs of values (m, n) **606**, **608** that will serve as the dimensions for one or more matrices, where m is an integer of the number of rows in a matrix and n is an integer of the number of columns in a matrix. The witness module **106** may generate each value m, n **606**, **608** using pseudorandom number generation. The

witness module **106** may generate twelve pairs of m, n values **606, 608**: (1) for use during encryption: (a) a character matrix, (b) a nibble matrix, and (c) a bit matrix; and (2) for use during decryption: (a) a bit matrix, (b) a nibble matrix, and (c) a character matrix. In some embodiments, the m and n values **606, 608** in a given value pair can be (even $\times$ even), (even $\times$ odd), or (odd $\times$ even). In some embodiments, the m and n values **606, 608** in a given pair may be (odd $\times$ odd). At least one property, such as a measure of randomness or unpredictability, of the pair of values (m, n) **606, 608** may be evaluated, and selection logic may be applied to the pair of values (m, n) **606, 608**. The selection logic may be configured to accept or reject the pair of values (m, n) **606, 608** based on at least one predefined criterion. The predefined criteria may relate to the complexity or unpredictability of a pair of values (m, n) and be satisfied when the pair of values (m, n) meets a predefined threshold for randomness or unpredictability. If the selection logic is executed and the pair of values (m, n) **606, 608** is rejected, another pair of values (m, n) may be generated at random and evaluated until a pair of values (m, n) is accepted by the selection logic. Once a pair of values (m, n) is accepted by the selection logic, the pair of values (m, n) may be assigned as the pair of values (m, n) **606, 608** to use as the dimensions for one or more matrices in the encryption process.

(92) In some embodiments, the witness module **106** may generate one or more deciders. A decider may include an integer. A decider may include a number of times a permutation is executed. A decider may include an encryption decider **610** or a decryption decider **612**. An encryption decider **610** may include the number of times a permutation must be executed to move a one-way function forward from the initiate state to an approximate midpoint in a mixing scheme **602**. In one embodiment, the witness module **106** may generate twelve encryption deciders **610**, one for each of: use of the Transformation Engine $P+1$ on the character matrix, use of the Transformation $P-1$ on the character matrix, use of Transformation Engine $m(P+1)$ on the character matrix, use of Transformation Engine $m(P-1)$ on the character matrix, use of the Transformation Engine $P+1$ on the nibble matrix, use of the Transformation Engine $P-1$ on the nibble matrix, use of Transformation Engine $m(P+1)$ on the nibble matrix, use of Transformation Engine $m(P-1)$ on the nibble matrix, use of the Transformation Engine $P+1$ on the bit matrix, use of the Transformation Engine $P-1$ on the bit matrix, use of Transformation Engine $m(P+1)$ on the bit matrix, or use of Transformation Engine $m(P-1)$ on the bit matrix.

(93) Similarly, in some embodiments, a decryption decider **612** may include a number of times a permutation must be executed to move a one-way function forward from the approximate midpoint to a final state that is identical to the initial state in the mixing scheme **602**. In one embodiment, the witness module **106** may generate twelve decryption deciders **612**, one for each of: use of the Transformation Engine $P+1$ on the bit matrix, use of the Transformation $P-1$ on the bit matrix, use of Transformation Engine $m(P+1)$ on the bit matrix, use of Transformation Engine $m(P-1)$ on the bit matrix, use of the Transformation Engine $P+1$ on the nibble matrix, use of the Transformation Engine $P-1$ on the nibble matrix, use of Transformation Engine $m(P+1)$ on the nibble matrix, use of Transformation Engine $m(P-1)$ on the nibble matrix, use of the Transformation Engine $P+1$ on the character matrix, use of the Transformation Engine $P-1$ on the character matrix, use of Transformation Engine $m(P+1)$ on the character matrix, or use of Transformation Engine $m(P-1)$ on the character matrix.

(94) As can be seen in FIG. **6B**, in one embodiment, the witness module **106** may generate twelve different encryption value sets **620(1)-(12)** for the encryption method **700**. The twelve encryption value sets **620** may include Character Matrix $P+1$ **620(1)**, Character Matrix $P-1$ **620(2)**, Character Matrix $m(P+1)$ **620(3)**, Character Matrix $m(P-1)$ **620(4)**, Nibble Matrix $P+1$ **620(5)**, Nibble Matrix $P-1$ **620(6)**, Nibble Matrix $m(P+1)$ **620(7)**, Nibble Matrix $m(P-1)$ **620(8)**, Bit Matrix $P+1$ **620(9)**, Bit Matrix $P-1$ **620(10)**, Bit Matrix $m(P+1)$ **620(11)**, and Bit Matrix $m(P-1)$ **620(12)**.

(95) In one embodiment, the witness module **106** may store the twelve encryption value sets **620** in the data storage **112**. In one embodiment, each encryption value set **620** may be stored as a file, such as a text file. The witness module **106** may send the twelve text files to the encryption module

108 for use in the encryption method **700** of FIG. 7.

(96) In another embodiment, the witness module **106** may be distributed to one or more third-party computing devices to generate the data employed by the encryption module **108** for use in the encryption method **700** of FIG. 7. The third-party computing devices may each enable users (e.g., via a computing device and Internet connection) to request and receive an encryption value set of unique integers from a third party associated with a third-party computing device. The third-party computing devices may generate the data for use in encryption, which may include one or more of a mixing scheme (i.e., the mixing scheme **602**), a bit value (i.e., the bit value **604**), one or more pairs of integer values (m, n) to serve as the dimensions for the one or more matrices (i.e., the pair of values (m, n) **606**, **608** accepted by the selection logic), where the letter m indicates a first matrix size (e.g., the number of rows in a matrix) and the letter n indicates a second matrix size (e.g., the number of columns in a matrix), an encryption decider (i.e., the encryption decider **610**), or a decryption decider (i.e., the decryption decider **612**). This data, when generated by a third-party computing device, may be used by that third-party computing device to generate one or more encryption value sets, each encryption value set including unique integers based on at least part of the generated data (i.e., a unique mixing scheme, bit value, pair of m, n values, encryption decider, decryption decider). For example, a user, via a user computing device, may send a request to a third-party computing device for an encryption value set and the third-party computing device may generate an encryption value set in response and then send the encryption value set to the user computing device over a network (e.g., the Internet) for the user to employ in performing the encryption method **700**. In another example, a user, via a user computing device, may send a request for at least one of the generated encryption value sets to a third-party computing device and the third-party computing device may send a response with an encryption value set to the user computing device over a network (e.g., the Internet) for use in performing the encryption method **700**. In some embodiments, the user computing device may generate supplementary data, such as a bit value, a mixing scheme, a pair of integer values (m, n) representing dimensions of a matrix for encrypting data, an encryption decider, and/or a decryption decider, when such data is not included in the encryption value set received from the third-party computing device. For example, Party A (e.g., third-party computing device) may generate an encryption value set with the bit value and mixing scheme and send the encryption value set to Party B, and Party B (e.g., user computing device) may generate the pair of m, n values, the encryption decider, and the decryption decider.

(97) Encryption and Decryption

(98) FIG. 7 depicts one embodiment of a method **700**. The method **700** may include an encryption method whereby the encryption module **108** may encrypt data to generate a ciphertext **400**. The method **700** may include generating the group policy **502** (step **702**). The method **700** may include generating the entity policy **504** (step **704**). The method **700** may include generating the ciphertext policy **506** (step **706**). The method **700** may include generating the instructions **404** (step **708**). The method **700** may include encrypting the data (step **710**). The method **700** may include compiling the ciphertext **400** from the results of steps **702-710** (step **712**). In one embodiment, the encryption module **108** may perform one or more of the steps **702-712** of the method **700**.

(99) In one embodiment, generating the group policy **502** (step **702**) may include the encryption module **108** retrieving the group policy **502** from the data storage **112** (e.g., from the first file of the second file directory). The group policy **502** may include a plaintext string. The encryption module **108** may retrieve the remainders stored with the group policy **502** or may calculate the remainders using the remainder generator discussed above in relation to step **208** of the method **200**. The encryption module **108** may append the remainders to the group policy **502**.

(100) In one embodiment, generating the entity policy **504** (step **704**) may include the encryption module **108** retrieving or generating the binary fingerprint of the user of the computing device **102**. Generating the entity policy **504** (step **704**) may include the encryption module requesting a copy of the binary fingerprint(s) from the user(s) of the other computing device(s) **120(1)-(n)** who will

receive the ciphertext **400**. In some embodiments, generating the entity policy **504** (step **704**) may include the encryption module **108** self-authenticating its own binary fingerprint. Generating the entity policy **504** (step **704**) may include creating the entity policy **504** to include the user of the computing devices' **102** binary fingerprint and the binary fingerprint(s) of the recipient(s).

(101) In one embodiment, the encryption module **108** self-authenticating may include the encryption module **108** (1) regenerating the user's USUP in the same manner as step **202** of the method **200**; (2) retrieving the user's USUP generated during the step **202** of the method **200**, which may be stored in the first file of the first file directory set up during the method **200**; and (3) retrieving a copy of the user's binary fingerprint from another source and deriving the USUP from the binary fingerprint. The other source may include another user (e.g., a user of another computing device **120**). The other user may have sent a copy of the first user's binary fingerprint in response to a request from the first user. The other user may have sent a copy of the first user's binary fingerprint in the entity policy **504** of the header **402** of a ciphertext **400**. The other source may include some other third-party source (e.g., the third-party computing device **1302** of FIG. **13**, discussed below). The encryption module **108** may determine whether all three USUPs match. In response to one of the USUPs not matching, the encryption module **108** may halt the encryption method **700**. In some embodiments, in response to the USUPs not matching, the encryption module **108** may revoke the USUP stored in the first file of the first file directory.

(102) In one embodiment, generating the ciphertext policy **506** (step **706**) may include the encryption module **108** retrieving the first unique identifier discussed above in relation to the ciphertext policy **506** from the data storage **112**. Generating the ciphertext policy **506** (step **706**) may include the encryption module **108** generating the second unique identifier using the process discussed above in relation to the ciphertext policy **506**. Certain portions of generating the ciphertext policy **506** (step **706**) may occur after the encryption of the data (step **710**) (e.g., generating the second unique identifier since the second unique identifier may be calculated from the encrypted body **406**). In some embodiments, the encryption module **108** may also retrieve the respective remainders associated with the first or second unique identifiers. In some embodiments, the encryption module **108** may generate the first or second unique identifiers and then calculate their respective remainders using the remainder generator discussed above in relation to step **208** of the method **200**.

(103) In one embodiment, generating the instructions **404** (step **708**) may include the encryption module **108** retrieving one or more files from the data storage **112** to generate the instructions **404**. In some embodiments, certain portions of the step **708** may occur after the encryption of the data (step **710**). For example, retrieving one or more files may include retrieving files that include the decryption values sets prepared during step **910** of the method **900** of FIG. **9**, discussed below.

(104) In one embodiment, encrypting the data (step **710**) may include the encryption module **108** receiving the data to be encrypted and encrypting the data to generate the body **406**. Details of the data encryption of the body **406** are discussed further below in relation to the method **900** of FIG. **9**. In one embodiment, compiling the ciphertext **400** (step **712**) may include the encryption module **108** generating the header **402** from the group policy **502**, entity policy **504**, and ciphertext policy **506** generated in steps **702-706** and including it as the header **402** of the ciphertext **400**. Compiling the ciphertext **400** (step **712**) may include the encryption module **108** including the instructions **404** generated in step **708** as the instructions **404** of the ciphertext **400**. Compiling the ciphertext **400** (step **712**) may include the encryption module **108** including the body **406** generated in step **710** as the body **406** of the ciphertext **400**.

(105) FIG. **8** depicts one embodiment of a method **800**. The method **800** may include a decryption method whereby the decryption module **110** may decrypt a ciphertext **400**. The method **800** may include decrypting the group policy **502** (step **802**). The method **800** may include decrypting the entity policy **504** (step **804**). The method **800** may include decrypting the ciphertext policy **506** (step **806**). The method **800** may include decrypting the instructions **404** (step **808**). The method

800 may include decrypting the body **406** (step **810**).

(106) In one embodiment, the decryption module **110** may retrieve the three binary values from the group policy **502** of the header **402** of the ciphertext **400**. The decryption module **110** may execute a remainder generator discussed above in relation to step **208** of the method **200** to calculate a remainder for each of the three binary values. The decryption module **110** may convert the remainders to a decimal value that represents the length of the group policy **502** plaintext string. The decryption module **110** may confirm that the decimal value matches the length of the group policy **502**. The decryption module **110** may confirm that the group policy **502** from the ciphertext **400** matches the group policy **502** stored on the receiving computing device **120**. If they do not match or if the length is different than the decimal value, the decryption module **110** may halt the decryption method **800**. If they do match, the decryption module **110** may proceed to step **804**.

(107) In one embodiment, decrypting the entity policy **504** (step **804**) may include the decryption module **110** retrieving the binary fingerprints from the entity policy **504**, identifying the recipient user's binary fingerprint, and decrypting the binary fingerprint to confirm that it matches the USUP of the decrypting user. Decrypting the entity policy **504** (step **804**) may include the decryption module **110** executing a self-authentication method on the binary fingerprints, described further below. In response to the decrypted USUP matching the USUP of the decrypting user (and, in some embodiments, the self-authenticating method confirming the authenticity of the binary fingerprints), the decryption module **110** may continue to step **806**. In response to USUPs not matching (or in response to the self-authenticating method failing), the decryption module **110** may halt the decryption method **800**.

(108) In one embodiment, the decryption module **110** self-authenticating may include the decryption module **110** (1) regenerating the user's USUP in the same manner as step **202** of the method **200**; (2) retrieving the user's USUP generated during the step **202** of the method **200**, which may be stored in the first file of the first file directory set up during the method **200**; and (3) retrieving a copy of the USUP from the user's binary fingerprint of the entity policy **504** of the ciphertext's **400** header **402**. The decryption module **110** may determine whether all three USUPs match. In response to one of the USUPs not matching, the decryption module **110** may halt the decryption method **800**. In some embodiments, the decryption module **110** may revoke the USUP stored in the first file of the first file directory.

(109) In one embodiment, decrypting the ciphertext policy **506** (step **806**) may include the decryption module **110** retrieving the three binary values appended to the ciphertext body **406**, which may represent the first unique identifier. The decryption module **110** may use the three binary values as inputs to three separate executions of a remainder generator discussed above in relation to step **208** of the method **200** to calculate a remainder for each binary value. The decryption module **110** may convert the three remainders to a decimal value, which may represent the length of the first unique identifier. The decryption module **110** may compare the received ciphertext policy **506** plaintext string and may compare it to the plaintext string stored on the recipient computing device **102**. The decryption module **110** may confirm that the decimal value matches the length of the ciphertext policy **506**. In response to the ciphertext policies **506** not matching or the length not matching the decimal value, the decryption module **110** may halt the method **800**.

(110) Otherwise, the decryption module **110** may continue by retrieving the three binary values appended to the ciphertext body **406** that represent the second unique identifier. The decryption module **110** may use the three binary values as input to three different executions of a remainder generator discussed above in relation to step **208** of the method **200** to calculate a remainder for each binary value and convert them to a decimal value. The decryption module **110** may calculate the number of total blocks in the ciphertext **400** and compares the result to the decimal value. If the decimal values are equal, the decryption module **110** may proceed to step **808**. Otherwise, the decryption module **110** may halt the method **800**.

(111) In one embodiment, decrypting the instructions **404** (step **808**) may include the decryption module **110** retrieving each decryption value set in the instructions **404**. The decryption module **110** may process the decryption value sets sequentially. In response to the decryption module **110** failing to process a decryption value set, the decryption module **110** may halt the method **800**. Otherwise, the decryption module **110** may continue and may decrypt the ciphertext **400** body **406** (step **810**).

(112) Ciphertext Body Encryption

(113) FIG. **9** depicts one embodiment of a method **900**. The method **900** may include a method to encrypt the data in order to generate the body **406** of the ciphertext **400**. The encryption module **108** may carry out one or more steps of the method **900**. In some embodiments, the step of encrypting the data (step **710**) of the method **700** may include one or more steps of the method **900**.

(114) The method **900** may include receiving the data to be encrypted (step **902**). The method **900** may include retrieving the encryption value sets **620** (step **904**). The method **900** may include generating one or more character matrices (step **906**). The method **900** may include executing one or more transformations on the one or more character matrices (step **908**). The method **900** may include preparing the decryption value sets (step **910**).

(115) In one embodiment, the method **900** may include receiving the data to be encrypted (step **902**). The data to be encrypted may sometimes be known as the “plaintext.” The data to be encrypted may include data received from a UI of a software application executing on the computing device **102**. The software application may include the encryption module or may include some other software. The data to be encrypted may include a file, for example, a file stored in the data storage **112**. The data to be encrypted may include text data, binary data, or data in some other format. In some embodiments, the data to be encrypted may include a single text string.

(116) In one or more embodiments, the method **900** may include retrieving the encryption value sets **620** (step **904**). The encryption value data sets may include at least one encryption value data set. The encryption value sets **620** may include the encryption value sets **620** generated by the witness module **106**, as discussed above. Retrieving the encryption value sets **620** (step **904**) may include retrieving the encryption value sets **620** from one or more files stored in the data storage **112** or from some other data storage. In some embodiments, the witness module **106** may read the encryption value sets **620** from the data storage **112** and provide the encryption value sets **620** to the encryption module **108**.

(117) In one embodiment, the method **900** may include generating one or more character matrices (step **906**). The one or more character matrices may include two matrices: a first character matrix and a second character matrix. The first character matrix may be size m , where m is the value m **606** from the “Character Matrix $P+1$ ” encryption value set **620(1)**. The second character matrix may be size n , where n is the value n **608** from the “Character Matrix $P+1$ ” encryption value set **620(1)**. The characters of the data to be encrypted may be loaded into the first and second matrices, row by row and adding padding if not all of the matrix cells are filled by the characters. In some embodiments, the encryption module **108** may add padding to the data to be encrypted.

(118) In one or more embodiments, the method **900** may include executing one or more transformations on the one or more character matrices (step **908**). In some embodiments, the one or more transformations may include a first transformation, a second transformation, and a third transformation. The encryption module **108** may take the output of a transformation and may use it as input to a subsequent transformation.

(119) In one embodiment, the first transformation may include a first cycle. The first cycle may include the encryption module **108** taking the first and second character matrices and running a character mixing scheme **602** on each character matrix. The character mixing **602** scheme may include the mixing scheme **602** from the “Character Matrix $P+1$ ” encryption value set **620(1)**. The first cycle may then include the encryption module **108** inputting the mixed first and second character matrices into the Transformation Engine $P+1$ and running the Transformation Engine $P+1$

the number of times equal to the encryption decider **610** from that encryption value set **620(1)**.

(120) In one embodiment, the first transformation may include a second cycle. The second cycle may include the encryption module **108** taking the first and second character matrices (after they have been through the first cycle) and running a second character mixing scheme **602** on the first and second character matrices. The second character mixing scheme **602** may include the mixing scheme **602** from the “Character Matrix P-1” encryption value set **620(2)**. The second cycle may include the encryption module **108** inputting the encryption decider **610** from that encryption value set **620(2)** into the Transformation Engine P-1 and using the Transformation Engine P-1 on the mixed first and second character matrices.

(121) In one embodiment, the first transformation may include a third cycle. The third cycle may include the encryption module **108** taking the first and second character matrices (after they have been through the second cycle) and running a third character mixing scheme **602** on the first and second character matrices. The third character mixing scheme **602** may include the mixing scheme value from the “Character Matrix m(P+1)” encryption value set **620(3)**. The third cycle may include the encryption module **108** inputting the encryption decider **610** from that encryption value set **620(3)** into the Transformation Engine m(P+1) and using the Transformation Engine m(P+1) on the mixed first and second character matrices.

(122) In one embodiment, the first transformation may include a fourth cycle. The fourth cycle may include the encryption module **108** taking the first and second character matrices (after they have been through the third cycle) and running a fourth character mixing scheme **602** on the first and second character matrices. The fourth character mixing scheme **602** may include the mixing scheme value from the “Character Matrix m(P-1) encryption value set **620(4)**. The fourth cycle may include the encryption module **108** inputting the encryption decider **610** from that encryption value set **620(4)** into the Transformation Engine m(P-1) and using the Transformation Engine m(P-1) on the mixed first and second character matrices.

(123) In one embodiment, the first transformation may include a fifth cycle. The fifth cycle may include the encryption module **108** running the Transformation Engine P-153 on the first and second character matrices (after they have been through the fourth cycle). The first transformation may then include splitting each character in each of the first and second character matrices into two nibbles in order to generate a first nibble matrix and a second nibble matrix.

(124) In one embodiment, the encryption module **108** may use the first and second nibble matrices as input to the second transformation. The second transformation may include a first cycle. The first cycle may include the encryption module **108** running a nibble mixing scheme **602** on each nibble matrix. The nibble mixing scheme **602** may include the mixing scheme **602** from the “Nibble Matrix P+1” encryption value set **620(5)**. The first cycle may include the encryption module **108** inputting the encryption decider **610** from that encryption value set **620(5)** into the Transformation Engine P+1 and using the Transformation Engine P+1 on the mixed first and second nibble matrices.

(125) In one embodiment, the second transformation may include a second cycle. The second cycle may include the encryption module **108** taking the first and second nibble matrices (after they have been through the first cycle) and running a nibble mixing **602** scheme on the first and second nibble matrices. The nibble mixing scheme **602** may include the mixing scheme **602** from the “Nibble Matrix P-1” encryption value set **620(6)**. The second cycle may include the encryption module **108** inputting the encryption decider **610** from that encryption value set **620(6)** into the Transformation Engine P-1 and using the Transformation Engine P-1 on the mixed first and second nibble matrices.

(126) In one embodiment, the second transformation may include a third cycle. The third cycle may include the encryption module **108** taking the first and second nibble matrices (after they have been through the second cycle) and running a third nibble mixing scheme **602** on the first and second nibble matrices. The third nibble mixing scheme **602** may include the mixing scheme value

from the “Nibble Matrix $m(P+1)$ ” encryption value set **620(7)**. The third cycle may include the encryption module **108** inputting the encryption decider **610** from that encryption value set **620(7)** into the Transformation Engine $m(P+1)$ and using the Transformation Engine $m(P+1)$ on the mixed first and second nibble matrices.

(127) In one embodiment, the second transformation may include a fourth cycle. The fourth cycle may include the encryption module **108** taking the first and second nibble matrices (after they have been through the third cycle) and running a fourth nibble mixing scheme **602** on the first and second nibble matrices. The fourth nibble mixing scheme **602** may include the mixing scheme value from the “Nibble Matrix $m(P-1)$ ” encryption value set **620(8)**. The fourth cycle may include the encryption module **108** inputting the encryption decider **610** from that encryption value set **620(8)** into the Transformation Engine $m(P-1)$ and using the Transformation Engine $m(P-1)$ on the mixed first and second nibble matrices.

(128) In one embodiment, the second transformation may include a fifth cycle. The fifth cycle may include the encryption module **108** running the Transformation Engine $P-153$ on the first and second nibble matrices (after they have been through the fourth cycle). The second transformation may include splitting each nibble in each of the first and second character matrices into four bits in order to generate a first bit matrix and a second bit matrix.

(129) In one embodiment, the encryption module **108** may use the first and second bit matrices as input to the third transformation. The third transformation may include a first cycle. The first cycle may include the encryption module **108** retrieving the bit value **604** from the “Bit Matrix $P+1$ ” encryption value set **620(9)** and retrieving the corresponding bit value table from the encryption module **108**. The encryption module **108** may use the bit value table to convert each cell in the first and second bit matrices into a different four-bit number according to the bit value table. The first cycle may include the encryption module **108** running a bit matrix mixing scheme **602** on each bit matrix. The bit mixing scheme **602** may include the mixing scheme value from the “Bit Matrix $P+1$ ” encryption value set **620(9)**. The first cycle may include the encryption module **108** inputting the encryption decider **610** from that encryption value set **620(9)** into the Transformation Engine $P+1$ and using the Transformation Engine $P+1$ on the mixed first and second bit matrices.

(130) In one embodiment, the third transformation may include a second cycle. The second cycle may include the encryption module **108** retrieving the bit value **604** from the “Bit Matrix $P-1$ ” encryption value set **620(10)** and retrieving the corresponding bit value table from the encryption module **108**. The encryption module **108** may use the bit value table to convert each cell in the first and second bit matrices into a different four-bit number according to the bit value table. The second cycle may include the encryption module **108** taking the first and second bit matrices (after they have been through the first cycle) and running a bit mixing scheme **602** on the first and second bit matrices. The bit mixing scheme **602** may include the mixing scheme value from the “Bit Matrix $P-1$ ” encryption value set **620(10)**. The second cycle may include the encryption module **108** inputting the encryption decider **610** from that encryption value set **620(10)** into the Transformation Engine $P-1$ and using the Transformation Engine $P-1$ on the mixed first and second bit matrices.

(131) In one embodiment, the third transformation may include a third cycle. The third cycle may include the encryption module **108** taking the first and second bit matrices (after they have been through the second cycle) and running a third bit mixing scheme **602** on the first and second bit matrices. The third bit mixing scheme **602** may include the mixing scheme value from the “Bit Matrix $m(P+1)$ ” encryption value set **620(11)**. The third cycle may include the encryption module **108** inputting the encryption decider **610** from that encryption value set **620(11)** into the Transformation Engine $m(P+1)$ and using the Transformation Engine $m(P+1)$ on the mixed first and second bit matrices.

(132) In one embodiment, the third transformation may include a fourth cycle. The fourth cycle may include the encryption module **108** taking the first and second bit matrices (after they have been through the third cycle) and running a third bit mixing scheme **602** on the first and second

nibble matrices. The fourth bit mixing scheme **602** may include the mixing scheme value from the “Bit Matrix $m(P-1)$ ” encryption value set **620(12)**. The fourth cycle may include the encryption module **108** inputting the encryption decider **610** from that encryption value set **620(12)** into the Transformation Engine $m(P-1)$ and using the Transformation Engine $m(P-1)$ on the mixed first and second bit matrices.

(133) In one embodiment, the third transformation may include a fifth cycle. The fifth cycle may include the encryption module **108** running the Transformation Engine $P-153$ on the first and second bit matrices (after they have been through the fourth cycle). At this point, the encryption of the plaintext may be complete. The encryption module **108** may include the encrypted plaintext as part of the body **406** of the ciphertext **400**.

(134) In some embodiments, the method **900** may include preparing the decryption value sets (step **910**). The decryption value sets may include at least one decryption value set. Preparing the decryption value sets (step **910**) may include the encryption module **108** copying the encryption value sets **620** and designating these copies as the decryption value sets. The encryption module **108** may then delete the encryption decider **610** from the decryption value sets so that each decryption value set includes a mixing scheme **602**, bit value **604**, m **606**, n **608**, and decryption decider **612**. In one embodiment, preparing the decryption value sets (step **910**) may include the encryption module **108** using a remainder generator (discussed above in relation to step **208** of the method **200**) to calculate three remainders for each m **606**, n **608**, and decryption decider **612** in each decryption value set. The decryption value sets may now be complete. The encryption module **108** may then include the decryption value sets as part of the ciphertext instructions **404** of the ciphertext **400**.

(135) FIG. **10A** depicts one embodiment of a dataflow **1000**. The data flow **1000** may show how the values mixing scheme **602**, bit value **604**, first matrix size **606**, second matrix size **608**, and decryption decider **612** of an encryption value set **620** (in the example of FIG. **10A**, the “Character Matrix $P+1$ ” encryption value set **620(1)**) is included in the decryption value set **1020** (in the example of FIG. **10A**, the “Character Matrix $P+1$ ” decryption value set). The values mixing scheme **602** and bit value **604** are included in the decryption value set **1020**. The values m **606**, n **608**, and decryption decider **612** are also included, but their remainders **1004** are also calculated by the remainder generator **1002** and included in the decryption value set **1020**. FIG. **10B** depicts a diagram indicating how each decryption value set **1020(1)-(12)** is derived from its corresponding encryption value set **620(1)-(12)** of FIG. **6B**.

(136) In one embodiment, the number of decryption value sets **1020** may match the number of encryption value sets **620**. In other embodiments, the number encryption value sets **620** and decryption value sets **1020** may not match. In some embodiments, the set of decryption value sets **1020** may include fewer than six decryption value sets **1020** or more than six decryption value sets **1020**. For example, there may be one decryption value set **1020**, two decryption value sets **1020**, three decryption value sets **1020**, four decryption value sets **1020**, five decryption value sets **1020**, seven decryption value sets **1020**, eight decryption value sets **1020**, nine decryption value sets **1020**, ten decryption value sets **1020**, eleven decryption value sets **1020**, or twelve decryption value sets **1020**. In some embodiments, the set of decryption value sets **1020** may include more than twelve decryption value sets **1020**.

(137) Ciphertext Body Decryption

(138) FIG. **11** depicts one embodiment of a method **1100**. The method **1100** may include a method to decrypt the body **406** of the ciphertext **400**. The decryption module **110** may carry out one or more steps of the method **1100**. In some embodiments, the step of decrypting the body **406** (step **810**) of the method **800** may include one or more steps of the method **1100**.

(139) The method **1100** may include receiving the ciphertext **400** body **406** (step **1102**). The method **1100** may include retrieving the decryption value sets **1020** (step **1104**). The method **1100** may include executing one or more transformations on the body **406** (step **1106**).

(140) In one embodiment, receiving the ciphertext **400** body **406** (step **1102**) may include receiving the binary string of the body **406** of the ciphertext **400** sent by the sending computing device **102**. The body **406** may have been encrypted according to the method **900** of FIG. **9**, discussed above. Receiving the ciphertext **400** body **406** (step **1102**) may include formatting the body **406** into a first and second bit matrix where each cell of each matrix includes a four-bit number. For example, the first four bits of the body **406** will be placed into the first cell of the first matrix, the second four bits of the body **406** will be placed into the second cell of the first matrix, and so on until the entire body **406** has been placed into the first and second matrices.

(141) In one embodiment, retrieving the decryption value sets **1020** (step **1104**) may include retrieving the decryption value sets **1020** that the decryption module **110** decrypted as part of the step **808** of the method **800**. The decryption module **110** may use the decryption value sets **1020** to decrypt the body **406**.

(142) In some embodiments, executing the one or more transformations on the body **406** (step **1106**) may include executing a first transformation, a second transformation, and a third transformation on the body **406**. The decryption module **110** may take the output of a transformation and may use it as input to a subsequent transformation.

(143) In one embodiment, the first transformation may include a first cycle. The first cycle may include the decryption module **110** running the Transformation Engine P-153 on the first and second bit matrices of the body **406**.

(144) In one embodiment, the first transformation may include a second cycle. The second cycle may include the decryption module **110** retrieving the bit value **604** from the “Bit Matrix m(P-1)” decryption value set **1020(12)** and retrieving the corresponding bit value table from the decryption module **110**. The decryption module **110** may use the bit value table to convert each cell in the first and second bit matrices (after they have been through the first cycle) into a different four-bit number according to the bit value table. The second cycle may include the decryption module **110** taking the first and second bit matrices (after they have been through the first cycle) and running a bit mixing scheme **602** on the first and second bit matrices. The bit mixing scheme **602** may include the bit mixing scheme **602** included in the “Bit Matrix m(P-1)” decryption value set **1020(12)**. The second cycle may include the decryption module **110** inputting the decryption decider **612** from the decryption value set **1020(12)** into the Transformation Engine m(P-1) and using the Transformation Engine m(P-1) on the mixed first and second bit matrices.

(145) In one embodiment, the first transformation may include a third cycle. The third cycle may include the decryption module **110** retrieving the bit value **604** from the “Bit Matrix m(P+1)” decryption value set **1020(11)** and retrieving the corresponding bit value table from the decryption module **110**. The decryption module **110** may use the bit value table to convert each cell in the first and second bit matrices (after they have been through the second cycle) into a different four-bit number according to the bit value table. The third cycle may include the decryption module **110** taking the first and second bit matrices and running a bit mixing scheme **602** on each bit matrix. The bit mixing scheme **602** may include the bit mixing scheme **602** of the “Bit Matrix m(P+1)” decryption value set **1020(11)**. The third cycle may include the decryption module **110** inputting the decryption decider **612** from the decryption value set **1020(11)** into the Transformation Engine m(P+1) and using the Transformation Engine m(P+1) on the mixed first and second bit matrices. The first transformation may include joining the bits in the bit matrices in to create first and second nibble matrices.

(146) In one embodiment, the first transformation may include a fourth cycle. The fourth cycle may include the decryption module **110** retrieving the bit value **604** from the “Bit Matrix P-1” decryption value set **1020(10)** and retrieving the corresponding bit value table from the decryption module **110**. The decryption module **110** may use the bit value table to convert each cell in the first and second bit matrices (after they have been through the third cycle) into a different four-bit number according to the bit value table. The fourth cycle may include the decryption module **110**

taking the first and second bit matrices and running a bit mixing scheme **602** on each bit matrix. The bit mixing scheme **602** may include the bit mixing scheme of the “Bit Matrix P-1” decryption value set **1020(10)**. The fourth cycle may include the decryption module **110** inputting the decryption decider **612** from the decryption value set **1020(10)** into the Transformation Engine P-1 and using the Transformation Engine P-1 on the mixed first and second bit matrices.

(147) In one embodiment, the first transformation may include a fifth cycle. The fifth cycle may include the decryption module **110** retrieving the bit value **604** from the “Bit Matrix P+1” decryption value set **1020(9)** and retrieving the corresponding bit value table from the decryption module **110**. The decryption module **110** may use the bit value table to convert each cell in the first and second bit matrices (after they have been through the fourth cycle) into a different four-bit number according to the bit value table. The fifth cycle may include the decryption module **110** taking the first and second bit matrices and running a bit mixing scheme **602** on each bit matrix. The bit mixing scheme **602** may include the bit mixing scheme of the “Bit Matrix P+1” decryption value set **1020(9)**. The fifth cycle may include the decryption module **110** inputting the decryption decider **612** from the decryption value set **1020(9)** into the Transformation Engine P+1 and using the Transformation Engine P+1 on the mixed first and second bit matrices.

(148) The first transformation may include joining the bits in the bit matrices in order to create first and second nibble matrices. In one embodiment, the decryption module **110** may use the first and second nibble matrices as input to the second transformation. In one embodiment, the second transformation may include a first cycle. The first cycle may include the decryption module **110** running the Transformation Engine P-153 on the first and second nibble matrices.

(149) In one embodiment, the second transformation may include a second cycle. The second cycle may include the decryption module **110** taking the first and second nibble matrices (after they have been through the first cycle) and running a nibble mixing scheme **602** on the first and second nibble matrices. The nibble mixing scheme **602** may include the nibble mixing scheme **602** included in the “Nibble Matrix m(P-1)” decryption value set **1020(8)**. The second cycle may include the decryption module **110** inputting the decryption decider **612** from the decryption value set **1020(8)** into the Transformation Engine m(P-1) and using the Transformation Engine m(P-1) on the mixed first and second nibble matrices.

(150) In one embodiment, the second transformation may include a third cycle. The third cycle may include the decryption module **110** running a nibble mixing scheme **602** on each nibble matrix (after they have been through the second cycle). The nibble mixing scheme **602** may include the nibble mixing scheme **602** included in the “Nibble Matrix m(P+1)” decryption value set **1020(7)**. The third cycle may include the decryption module **110** inputting the decryption decider **612** from the decryption value set **1020(7)** into the Transformation Engine m(P+1) and using the Transformation Engine m(P+1) on the first and second nibble matrices. The second transformation may include joining each nibble in each of the first and second nibble matrices in order to generate a first character matrix and a second character matrix.

(151) In one embodiment, the second transformation may include a fourth cycle. The fourth cycle may include the decryption module **110** taking the first and second nibble matrices (after they have been through a third cycle) and running a nibble mixing scheme **602** on the first and second nibble matrices. The nibble mixing scheme **602** may include the nibble mixing scheme included in the “Nibble Matrix P-1” decryption value set **1020(6)**. The fourth cycle may include the decryption module **110** inputting the decryption decider **612** from the decryption value set **1020(6)** into the Transformation Engine P-1 and using the Transformation Engine P-1 on the mixed first and second nibble matrices.

(152) In one embodiment, the second transformation may include a fifth cycle. The fifth cycle may include the decryption module **110** taking the first and second matrices (after they have been through a fourth cycle) and running a nibble mixing scheme **602** on the first and second nibble matrices. The nibble mixing scheme **602** may include the nibble mixing scheme included in the

“Nibble Matrix P+1” decryption value set **1020(5)**. The fifth cycle may include the decryption module **110** inputting the decryption decider **612** from the decryption value set **1020(5)** into the Transformation Engine P+1 and using the Transformation Engine P+1 on the mixed first and second nibble matrices.

(153) The second transformation may include joining each nibble in each of the first and second nibble matrices in order to generate first and second character matrices. In one embodiment, the decryption module **110** may use the first and second character matrices as input to the third transformation. In one embodiment, the third transformation may include a first cycle. The first cycle may include the decryption module **110** running the Transformation Engine P-153 on the first and second character matrices.

(154) In one embodiment, the third transformation may include a second cycle. The second cycle may include the decryption module **110** taking the first and second character matrices (after they have been through the first cycle) and running a character mixing scheme **602** on the first and second character matrices. The character mixing scheme **602** may include the character mixing scheme **602** included in the “Character Matrix m(P-1)” decryption value set **1020(4)**. The second cycle may include the decryption module **110** inputting the decryption decider **612** from the decryption value set **1020(4)** into the Transformation Engine m(P-1) and using the Transformation Engine m(P-1) on the mixed first and second character matrices.

(155) The third transformation may include a third cycle. The third cycle may include the decryption module **110** taking the first and second character matrices (after they have been through the second cycle) and running a character mixing scheme **602** on each character matrix. The character mixing scheme **602** may include the character mixing scheme **602** included in the “Character Matrix m(P+1)” decryption value set **1020(3)**. The third cycle may include the decryption module **110** inputting the decryption decider **612** from the decryption value set **1020(3)** into the Transformation Engine m(P+1) and using the Transformation Engine m(P+1) on the mixed first and second character matrices.

(156) In one embodiment, the third transformation may include a fourth cycle. The fourth cycle may include the decryption module **110** taking the first and second character matrices (after they have been through a third cycle) and running a character mixing scheme **602** on the first and second character matrices. The character mixing scheme **602** may include the character mixing scheme included in the “Character Matrix P-1” decryption value set **1020(2)**. The fourth cycle may include the decryption module **110** inputting the decryption decider **612** from the decryption value set **1020(2)** into the Transformation Engine P-1 and using the Transformation Engine P-1 on the mixed first and second character matrices.

(157) In one embodiment, the third transformation may include a fifth cycle. The fifth cycle may include the decryption module **110** taking the first and second character matrices (after they have been through a fourth cycle) and running a mixing scheme **602** on the first and second character matrices. The character mixing scheme **602** may include the character mixing scheme included in the “Character Matrix P+1” decryption value set **1020(1)**. The fifth cycle may include the decryption module **110** inputting the decryption decider **612** from the decryption value set **1020(1)** into the Transformation Engine P+1 and using the Transformation Engine P+1 on the mixed first and second character matrices. At this point, the first and second character matrices may form the decrypted plaintext. The method **1100** may include removing any padding in the plaintext. At this point, the decryption of the body **406** is complete.

(158) Proof of Work

(159) In one embodiment, the systems and methods disclosed herein may provide a proof-of-work protocol. The proof-of-work protocol may include one or more procedures, called gateway proofs, that the sender of a ciphertext **400** and the receiver of the ciphertext **400** each complete. A gateway proof may demonstrate that the sender or receiver expended a certain amount of computational effort to complete the gateway proof. The sender or receiver of the ciphertext **400** may complete a

gateway proof in non-deterministic polynomial time.

(160) FIG. 12 depicts one embodiment of a data flow 1200 showing the operation of one embodiment of a proof-of-work. In one embodiment, each gateway proof or other operation must be completed (by the respective sender or recipient) in order to move on to the next gateway proof or operation. In some embodiments, the operations 1202-1212 performed by the sender may be performed by the encryption module 108 of the sender's computing device 102. The operations 1214-1226 performed by the recipient may be performed by the decryption module 110 of the recipient's computing device 120.

(161) In one embodiment, the first gateway proof 1202 may include the sender generating the group policy 502. This may include one or more operations discussed above in relation to step 702 of the method 700 of FIG. 7. The second gateway proof 1204 may include the sender generating the entity policy 504. This may include one or more operations discussed above in relation to step 704 of the method 700. The third gateway proof 1206 may include the sender generating the first unique identifier of the ciphertext policy 506, which may include the string of text established by the user, group, or organization using the computing device 102 as discussed above in relation to FIG. 5. The fourth gateway proof 1208 may include the sender generating the second unique identifier of the ciphertext policy 506, which may include the three binary values that will be appended to the ciphertext body 406. The third and fourth gateway proofs 1206, 1208 may include one or more operations discussed above in relation to step 706 of the method 700.

(162) In one embodiment, after completion of the four gateways 1202-1208 by the sender, the witness module 106 may, as part of the operation 1210, generate the encryption value sets 620 used in the encryption of the ciphertext 400, as discussed above. The encryption module 108, as part of operation 1212, may use the encryption value sets 620 generated in operations 1210 to encrypt the data to be encrypted to generate the body 406, as discussed above in relation to the method 900 of FIG. 9. The encryption module 108 may use the results of the gateway proofs 1202-1208, the witness operations 1210, and the ciphertext encryption 1212 to create the ciphertext 400, as discussed above in relation to steps 708-712 of the method 700. The sender may then send the ciphertext 400 to the recipient.

(163) The recipient may receive the ciphertext 400. In one embodiment, the first gateway proof 1214 may include the recipient determining whether the group policy 502 of the header 402 of the received ciphertext 400 matches the group policy 502 the recipient has stored (e.g., in the data storage 112 of the recipient's computing device 120). The second gateway proof 1216 may include the recipient determining whether the USUP in the entity policy 504 of the header 402 of the received ciphertext 400 matches the USUP associated with the sender that the recipient has stored. The third gateway proof 1218 may include the recipient determining whether the first unique identifier of the ciphertext policy 506 of the received ciphertext 400 matches the first unique identifier established during the setup process. The fourth gateway proof 1220 may include the recipient determining whether the second unique identifier of the ciphertext policy 506 of the received ciphertext 400 matches the ciphertext's 400 length.

(164) In one embodiment, the recipient may perform an integrity check 1222. The integrity check 1222 may include the decryption module 120 recreating the file directories and file configurations the setup module 104 generated during the setup process of the method 200 of FIG. 2. The recreated file directories and file configurations may include copies of the file directories and configurations set up by the setup module 104 of the sender or of the receiver.

(165) In some embodiments, the recipient may decrypt the instructions 404 of the ciphertext 400 (1224). Decrypting the instructions 404 (1224) may include one or more operations of the decrypting the instructions 404 step 808 of the method 800 of FIG. 8. In some embodiments, the recipient may decrypt the ciphertext body 406 (1226). Decrypting the body 406 (1226) may include one or more of the steps of the method 900 of FIG. 9.

(166) Binary Fingerprint Storage

(167) FIG. 13 depicts one embodiment of a system **1300**. The system **1300** may include the computing device **102** of FIG. 1. The system **1300** may include a third-party computing device **1302**. The third-party computing device **1302** may include a binary fingerprint storage **1304**. The binary fingerprint storage **1304** may store one or more binary fingerprints. The computing device **102** and the third-party computing device **1302** may be in data communication with each other over the data network **130** of FIG. 1. In one embodiment, the third-party computing device **1302** may include at least two functions: storing copies of binary fingerprints and sending a copy of a binary fingerprint to a computing device **102** in response to a request. In some embodiments, the third-party computing device **1302** may not generate binary fingerprints, only store them and send copies of them.

(168) In one embodiment, during or after the setup process of the method **200** of FIG. 2, the setup module **104** of the computing device **102** may send the binary fingerprint of a user to the third-party computing device **1302** for storage of the binary fingerprint. The setup module **104** may send an identifier to be associated with the binary fingerprint. The identifier may include an employee ID number of the user whose binary fingerprint it is. The identifier may include an email address, a username, or some other identifying information.

(169) In one embodiment, as part of an operation of the computing device **102**, such as the execution of a self-authentication operation, discussed above, the computing device **102** may request a binary fingerprint. The request may include an identifier associated with the requested binary fingerprint. The third-party computing device **1302** may send the requested binary fingerprint in response to the request. The binary fingerprint may include the binary fingerprint of the requesting user. The binary fingerprint may include a binary fingerprint of another user of another computing device **120**.

(170) In one embodiment, the binary fingerprint storage **1304** may include one or more files stored in a file system of the third-party computing device. The binary fingerprint storage **1304** may include a database. The binary fingerprint storage **1304** may include a distributed ledger, such as a blockchain. A binary fingerprint may be stored in a distributed ledger transaction of the distributed ledger. In an embodiment where the binary fingerprint storage **1304** includes a distributed ledger, the third-party computing device **1302** may include a distributed ledger or blockchain node. In other embodiments, the third-party computing device **1302** may be in data communication with a distributed ledger/blockchain node.

(171) Software/Hardware

(172) While the making and using of various embodiments of the present disclosure are discussed in detail herein, it should be appreciated that the present disclosure provides many applicable inventive concepts that are embodied in a wide variety of specific contexts. The specific embodiments discussed herein are merely illustrative of specific ways to make and use the disclosure and do not delimit the scope of the disclosure. Those of ordinary skill in the art will recognize numerous equivalents to the specific apparatuses, systems, and methods described herein. Such equivalents are considered to be within the scope of this disclosure and may be covered by the claims.

(173) Furthermore, the described features, structures, or characteristics of the disclosure may be combined in any suitable manner in one or more embodiments. In the description contained herein, numerous specific details are provided, such as examples of programming, software, user selections, hardware, hardware circuits, hardware chips, or the like, to provide understanding of embodiments of the disclosure. One skilled in the relevant art will recognize, however, that the disclosure may be practiced without one or more of the specific details, or with other methods, components, materials, apparatuses, devices, systems, and so forth. In other instances, well-known structures, materials, or operations may not be shown or described in detail to avoid obscuring aspects of the disclosure.

(174) These features and advantages of the embodiments will become more fully apparent from the

description and appended claims or may be learned by the practice of embodiments as set forth herein. As will be appreciated by one skilled in the art, aspects of the present disclosure may be embodied as an apparatus, system, method, computer program product, or the like. Accordingly, aspects of the present disclosure may take the form of an entirely hardware embodiment, an entirely software embodiment (including firmware, resident software, micro-code, etc.) or an embodiment combining software and hardware aspects that may all generally be referred to herein as a “circuit,” “module,” or “system.” Furthermore, aspects of the present disclosure may take the form of a computer program product embodied in one or more computer-readable media having program code embodied thereon.

(175) In some embodiments, a module may be implemented as a hardware circuit comprising custom (very large-scale integration) VLSI circuits or gate arrays, off-the-shelf semiconductors such as logic chips, transistors, or other discrete components. A module may also be implemented in programmable hardware devices such as field programmable gate arrays, programmable array logic, programmable logic devices or the like.

(176) Modules may also be implemented in software for execution by various types of processors. An identified module of program code may, for instance, comprise one or more physical or logical blocks of computer instructions which may, for instance, be organized as an object, procedure, or function. Nevertheless, the executables of an identified module need not be physically located together, but may comprise disparate instructions stored in different locations which, when joined logically together, comprise the module and achieve the stated purpose for the module.

(177) Indeed, a module of program code may be a single instruction, or many instructions, and may even be distributed over several different code segments, among different programs, and across several memory devices. Similarly, operational data may be identified and illustrated herein within modules, and may be embodied in any suitable form and organized within any suitable type of data structure. The operational data may be collected as a single data set, or may be distributed over different locations including over different storage devices, and may exist, at least partially, merely as electronic signals on a system or network. Where a module or portions of a module are implemented in software, the program code may be stored and/or propagated on in one or more computer-readable media.

(178) In some embodiments, a module may include a smart contract hosted on a blockchain. The functionality of the smart contract may be executed by a node (or peer) of the blockchain network. One or more inputs to the smart contract may be read or detected from one or more transactions stored on or referenced by the blockchain. The smart contract may output data based on the execution of the smart contract as one or more transactions to the blockchain. A smart contract may implement one or more methods or algorithms described herein.

(179) The computer program product may include a computer-readable storage medium (or media) having computer-readable program instructions thereon for causing a processor to carry out aspects of the present disclosure. A computer-readable storage medium, as used herein, is not to be construed as being transitory signals per se, such as radio waves or other freely propagating electromagnetic waves, electromagnetic waves propagating through a waveguide or other transmission media (e.g., light pulses passing through a fiber-optic cable), or electrical signals transmitted through a wire.

(180) Computer-readable program instructions described herein can be downloaded to respective computing/processing devices from a computer-readable storage medium or to an external computer or external storage device via a network, for example, the Internet, a local area network, a wide area network and/or a wireless network. The network may comprise copper transmission cables, optical transmission fibers, wireless transmission, routers, firewalls, switches, gateway computers and/or edge servers. A network adapter card or network interface in each computing/processing device receives computer-readable program instructions from the network and forwards the computer-readable program instructions for storage in a computer-readable

storage medium within the respective computing/processing device.

(181) Computer-readable program instructions for carrying out operations of the present disclosure may be assembler instructions, instruction-set-architecture (ISA) instructions, machine instructions, machine dependent instructions, microcode, firmware instructions, state-setting data, or either source code or object code written in any combination of one or more programming languages, including an object oriented programming language such as Smalltalk, C++ or the like, and conventional procedural programming languages, such as the “C” programming language or similar programming languages. The computer-readable program instructions may execute entirely on the user's computer, partly on the user's computer, as a stand-alone software package, partly on the user's computer and partly on a remote computer or entirely on the remote computer or server. In the latter scenario, the remote computer may be connected to the user's computer through any type of network, including a local area network (LAN) or a wide area network (WAN), or the connection may be made to an external computer (for example, through the Internet using an Internet Service Provider). In some embodiments, electronic circuitry including, for example, programmable logic circuitry, field-programmable gate arrays (FPGA), or programmable logic arrays (PLA) may execute the computer-readable program instructions by utilizing state information of the computer-readable program instructions to personalize the electronic circuitry, in order to perform aspects of the present disclosure.

(182) Aspects of the present disclosure are described herein with reference to flowchart illustrations or block diagrams of methods, apparatuses, systems, algorithms, or computer program products according to embodiments of the disclosure. It will be understood that each block of the flowchart illustrations and/or block diagrams, and combinations of blocks in the flowchart illustrations and/or block diagrams, can be implemented by computer-readable program instructions.

(183) These computer-readable program instructions may be provided to a processor of a general purpose computer, special purpose computer, or other programmable data processing apparatus to produce a machine, such that the instructions, which execute via the processor of the computer or other programmable data processing apparatus, create means for implementing the functions/acts specified in the flowchart and/or block diagram block or blocks. These computer-readable program instructions may also be stored in a computer-readable storage medium that can direct a computer, a programmable data processing apparatus, and/or other devices to function in a particular manner, such that the computer-readable storage medium having instructions stored therein comprises an article of manufacture including instructions which implement aspects of the function/act specified in the flowchart and/or block diagram block or blocks.

(184) The computer-readable program instructions may also be loaded onto a computer, other programmable data processing apparatus, or other device to cause a series of operational steps to be performed on the computer, other programmable apparatus or other device to produce a computer implemented process, such that the instructions which execute on the computer, other programmable apparatus, or other device implement the functions/acts specified in the flowchart and/or block diagram block or blocks.

(185) The schematic flow chart diagrams included herein are generally set forth as logical flow chart diagrams. As such, the depicted order and labeled steps are indicative of one embodiment of the presented method. Other steps and methods may be conceived that may be equivalent in function, logic, or effect to one or more steps, or portions thereof, of the illustrated method. Additionally, the format and symbols employed are provided to explain the logical steps of the method and are understood not to limit the scope of the method. Although various arrow types and line types may be employed in the flow chart diagrams, they are understood not to limit the scope of the corresponding method. Indeed, some arrows or other connectors may be used to indicate only the logical flow of the method. For instance, an arrow may indicate a waiting or monitoring period of unspecified duration between enumerated steps of the depicted method. Additionally, the order in which a particular method occurs may or may not strictly adhere to the order of the

corresponding steps shown.

(186) The schematic flowchart diagrams and/or schematic block diagrams in the Figures illustrate the architecture, functionality, and operation of possible implementations of apparatuses, systems, methods and computer program products according to various embodiments of the present disclosure. In this regard, each block in the schematic flowchart diagrams and/or schematic block diagrams may represent a module, segment, or portion of code, which comprises one or more executable instructions of the program code for implementing the specified logical function(s).

(187) It should also be noted that, in some alternative implementations, the functions noted in the block may occur out of the order noted in the Figures. For example, two blocks shown in succession may, in fact, be executed substantially concurrently, or the blocks may sometimes be executed in the reverse order, depending upon the functionality involved. Other steps and methods may be conceived that are equivalent in function, logic, or effect to one or more blocks, or portions thereof, of the illustrated Figures.

(188) Although various arrow types and line types may be employed in the flowchart and/or block diagrams, they are understood not to limit the scope of the corresponding embodiments. Indeed, some arrows or other connectors may be used to indicate only the logical flow of the depicted embodiment. For instance, an arrow may indicate a waiting or monitoring period of unspecified duration between enumerated steps of the depicted embodiment. It will also be noted that each block of the block diagrams and/or flowchart diagrams, and combinations of blocks in the block diagrams and/or flowchart diagrams, can be implemented by special purpose hardware-based systems that perform the specified functions or acts, or combinations of special purpose hardware and program code.

(189) Thus, although there have been described particular embodiments of the present disclosure of a new and useful SYSTEMS AND METHODS FOR DATA ENCRYPTION, DECRYPTION, AND AUTHENTICATION it is not intended that such references be construed as limitations upon the scope of this disclosure.

Claims

1. A computer-implemented method for generating a pair of integer values as matrix dimensions for encrypting data, comprising: generating a first pair of integer values (m , n) at random, wherein m represents a number of rows in a matrix and n represents a number of columns in a matrix; evaluating at least one property of the first pair of integer values, wherein the at least one property comprises a measure of randomness; applying selection logic to the first pair of integer values, wherein the selection logic is configured to accept or reject a pair of integer values based on at least one predefined criterion that is satisfied when the pair of integer values meets a predefined threshold for randomness; determining whether the first pair of integer values is accepted or rejected based on the applied selection logic; assigning the first pair of integer values as dimensions of a matrix for encrypting data when the first pair of integer values is accepted based on the applied selection logic; selecting an unordered combination of two or more transformation engines, wherein the two or more transformation engines comprise two or more of Transformation Engine $P+1$, Transformation Engine $P-1$, Transformation Engine $P-153$, Transformation Engine $m(P+1)$, or Transformation Engine $m(P-1)$, and wherein each Transformation Engine executes a different entropy function on the matrix; and performing an encryption operation with the selected unordered combination of two or more transformation engines, wherein the encryption operation is agnostic to the order in which the transformation engines of the selected unordered combination of two or more transformation engines are applied.

2. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, further comprising: generating the first pair of integer values (m , n) at random.

3. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, further comprising: subsequent to determining

whether the first pair of integer values is accepted or rejected based on the applied selection logic; generating a second pair of integer values when the first pair of integer values is rejected based on the applied selection logic; evaluating at least one property of the second pair of integer values, wherein the at least one property comprises a measure of randomness; applying the selection logic to the second pair of integer values; and determining whether the second pair of integer values is accepted or rejected based on the applied selection logic; wherein assigning the first pair of integer values as the dimensions of the matrix for encrypting data comprises assigning the second pair of integer values as the dimensions of the matrix for encrypting data when the second pair of integer values is accepted based on the applied selection logic.

4. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein the steps of generating and evaluating a pair of integer values is repeated until a pair of integer values is accepted by the selection logic.

5. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein the matrix comprises a character matrix, a nibble matrix, or a bit matrix.

6. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein selecting the unordered combination of two or more transformation engines comprises randomly selecting the two or more transformation engines.

7. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein performing the encryption operation with the selected unordered combination of two or more transformation engines comprises: providing the matrix for encrypting data to each transformation engine of the selected unordered combination of two or more transformation engines; and executing each transformation engine of the two or more transformation engines on the matrix for encrypting data.

8. The computer-implemented method of claim 7, wherein executing each transformation engine of the two or more transformation engines on the matrix for encrypting data comprises executing an entropy function of each transformation engine of the two or more transformation engines on the matrix for encrypting data.

9. The computer-implemented method of claim 7, wherein providing the matrix for encrypting data to each transformation engine of the selected unordered combination of two or more transformation engines comprises: executing a mixing scheme on the matrix for encrypting data; and inputting the matrix for encrypting data into each transformation engine of the two or more transformation engines.

10. The computer-implemented method of claim 9, wherein the mixing scheme comprises data indicating a sequence of executions of the two or more transformation engines.

11. The computer-implemented method of claim 10, further comprising: generating the sequence of executions of the two or more transformation engines at random.

12. The computer-implemented method of claim 11, wherein generating the sequence of executions of the two or more transformation engines at random comprises selecting a length of the sequence at random, wherein the length of the sequence comprises a number of executions of each of the two or more transformation engines.

13. The computer-implemented method of claim 11, wherein generating the sequence of executions of the two or more transformation engines at random comprises selecting a length of the sequence at random, wherein the length of the sequence comprises a content of the sequence including whether each slot in the sequence includes an execution of at least one of the two or more transformation engines.
